



Northwind Labs brand guidelines

Version 1.0.0 · Updated 2026-10-02 · WCAG 2.2 AA

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Introduction

Northwind Labs turns climate data into decisions for city governments and utilities. The people we serve — sustainability officers, utility engineers, investors and partners — judge us on whether our work is clear, accurate and trustworthy. A consistent, accessible brand is part of that proof: every chart, report, slide and post should look and sound like it came from the same careful team.

Why this guide exists

This guide sets out how to present Northwind Labs everywhere the brand appears: our logo, colours, typography, layout, imagery, data visualisation, motion, voice, writing style, digital products, social media, print, presentations, events and partnerships. It also explains the reasons behind each rule, so you can make good decisions in situations the guide does not cover.

It is built from one source of truth. The colour values, type sizes, spacing, logo files and social templates you see here are generated from the same data as the design tokens and the asset kit. If you copy a value from this guide, it will match the code and the files.

Who it is for

- **Marketing and communications staff** writing campaigns, web pages, reports and social posts.
- **Designers and agencies** creating artwork, templates, motion and events.
- **Product designers and developers** building dashboards, data products and the website, using the design tokens.
- **Everyone else at Northwind Labs** who writes an email, builds a slide deck or speaks for us on LinkedIn.
- **Partners, suppliers and printers** who need to reproduce our identity correctly.

How to use it

1. **Start with the foundations.** Read Brand foundations and Voice and tone first. They explain who we are and how we sound, and most other decisions follow from them.
2. **Find the chapter for your task.** Each chapter stands on its own: Logo, Colour, Typography and Social media are the ones most people need.
3. **Use the files, not screenshots.** Download logos, templates and tokens from the asset library listed in Legal, governance and assets. Never recreate the logo or retype colour values by eye.
4. **Check accessibility as you go.** The Accessibility chapter includes a checklist for every format.

What is mandatory and what is flexible

Mandatory (must follow)	Flexible (use judgement)
Logo artwork, clear space, minimum sizes and misuse rules	Layout composition within the grid
Approved colour pairings and contrast thresholds	Choice of supporting tints from the tonal scales
Typefaces, minimum text sizes and line spacing	Photography subjects within the imagery principles
Accessibility requirements in every chapter	Tone, adjusted to the context and audience
Legal lines, trademark and disclosure rules	Content pillars and campaign ideas on social

Rules written as "must", "never" or in a **Don't** callout are mandatory. Rules written as "we recommend" or "usually" leave room for judgement, as long as the result stays accessible and recognisably Northwind Labs.

Do ask the brand owner before you break a rule. There may be an approved exception, or the guide may need updating.

Don't treat an earlier piece of work as precedent if it breaks this guide. Follow the guide, and tell us about the gap.

Our accessibility commitment

We design everything to meet WCAG 2.2 AA as a minimum, because our audiences include people with low vision, colour-vision deficiency, cognitive and motor disabilities, and because many of our clients are public bodies with their own legal accessibility duties. Accessibility is built into every rule in this guide, not added as a separate step: colour pairings are tested, type sizes have minimums, charts never rely on colour alone, and every image and video needs alt text or captions. If something you are making cannot meet these standards, ask for help before you publish.

Getting help

Questions, approvals and requests for new assets go to the Marketing team at hello@northwindlabs.example. If you find a mistake, a gap or a rule that no longer works, tell us. The guide is reviewed on a regular cycle, described in Legal, governance and assets.

About this guide

Item	Detail
Organisation	Northwind Labs
Guide version	1.0.0
Last updated	2026-10-02
Brand owner	Marketing team
Contact	hello@northwindlabs.example
Accessibility standard	WCAG 2.2 AA
Language and spelling	en-GB
Review cadence	Every 12 months, and after any rebrand or platform change

Assumptions to confirm:

- Brand colours were extracted from the logo; confirm exact values against the master artwork or existing specifications.
- CMYK values are mathematical conversions; confirm with your printer and choose Pantone matches from a physical swatch book.
- Social platform specifications were last reviewed on the date in the social chapter; verify before production.
- Non-interactive run: no questions were asked; defaults below were chosen by the style guide team and need confirmation.
- Colour names (Fjord Teal, Polar Night, Daybreak Amber) are proposals; the logo hex values are unchanged.
- Typefaces Manrope (display) and Inter (body), both free under SIL OFL 1.1, are recommendations matched to the geometric logo; replace with licensed brand fonts if they exist.
- Colour proportions (60% neutral, 20% Fjord Teal, 15% Polar Night, 5% Daybreak Amber) are a proposed starting point.
- Corner radius scale (2/4/8/16px) is a proposal reflecting the logo's sharp triangles inside a round container.
- Social handles are not known; @northwindlabs is used as an illustrative placeholder and must be confirmed or replaced.
- Social platforms set to LinkedIn, X, YouTube, Instagram and web sharing as supplied by the user.
- The supplied symbol file (circle with amber peak) is used for avatars, favicons and app icons.
- Mission, vision, values, positioning, tagline ('Clear data for climate decisions.') and boilerplate are brand-team drafts; none were supplied. Run trademark and domain checks on the tagline.
- Positioning proof point (we publish methods, assumptions and uncertainty) must be confirmed as true before external use.
- Voice adds 'Clear' as a fourth attribute; house style uses no serial comma, single quotation marks, spaced en dashes, singular 'data', IPCC-style likelihood terms and metric units first.
- Residents and elected members are treated as a secondary audience.
- Clear space refined to the height of the lowercase 'o' (about 28% of logo height); minimum digital size raised to 160px so 'LABS' stays legible.
- Recommended icon set: Material Symbols Sharp (Apache 2.0). Chart palettes are defined in chapter 09 only (no schema field).

- Office font substitutes: Arial for Manrope and Inter, Consolas for JetBrains Mono (Aptos as a Microsoft 365 alternative).
- Brand architecture assumed to be a branded house, with products endorsed 'by Northwind Labs'.
- Approval turnaround times, social posting frequencies, response times, monitoring hours, record-keeping period and named roles are proposals.
- Content pillars and shares (35/20/20/15/10) and the topic hashtag set are proposals; the social chapter's five pillars were adopted over the strategist's three-pillar draft for consistency.
- Minimum print sizes (11pt body, 12pt for reports to public bodies, 16pt large print, 24pt slides) and a 2-working-day acknowledgement for accessible-format requests are proposals.
- Address, phone, website and registered-company details are placeholders; all example figures in the guide are illustrative, not Northwind Labs data.
- Social platform specifications next reviewed 2 April 2027.

Brand foundations

Everything else in this guide, from the colour of a chart to the wording of an error message, should trace back to this chapter. Northwind Labs works in climate data analytics for city governments and utilities, where people make long-lived, public, expensive decisions. Our foundations exist so that every audience, from a utility engineer checking a load profile to an investor reading a board pack, meets the same organisation: confident, precise and optimistic.

Note Northwind Labs did not supply a mission, vision, values, positioning or tagline. Every statement marked *Proposed — confirm with leadership*: is a draft written by the brand team from the inputs we received: the industry, the audiences, the personality ("confident, precise, optimistic") and the logo. Leadership should edit and approve these drafts before the guide is published. Do not quote them externally until they are approved.

What we know and what we propose

Item	Status	Source
Name: Northwind Labs	Confirmed	Supplied by the organisation
Industry: climate data analytics for city governments and utilities	Confirmed	Supplied by the organisation
Audiences: city sustainability officers, utility engineers, investors and climate-tech partners	Confirmed	Supplied by the organisation
Personality: confident, precise, optimistic	Confirmed	Supplied by the organisation
Mission, vision, values, positioning, tagline, boilerplate	Proposed	Brand team draft for approval
History, customers, results, awards, locations, team size	Not supplied	Do not state any of these until they are verified

Mission

The mission says what we do, for whom and why, in one sentence.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: **We turn climate data into clear, trustworthy evidence, so city governments and utilities can make better decisions for the places and people they serve.**

Vision

The vision is the future we are working towards. It should stay true for years, even as our products change.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: **A future where every city and utility can plan, invest and act on climate with confidence, because the evidence is clear to everyone who relies on it.**

Positioning

Positioning tells the team where we fit in the market. It is an internal tool, not a line to publish.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: For city sustainability officers and utility engineers who must make high-stakes climate decisions with complex and incomplete data, Northwind Labs is the climate data analytics partner that turns that data into clear, decision-ready evidence, because we show our methods, our assumptions and our uncertainty, not just our answers.

Warning The "because" in a positioning statement must be provably true. Before using this proof point in sales or investor material, confirm that our products and reports really do publish methods, assumptions and uncertainty ranges. If they do not yet, change the proof point rather than the product description.

Values

Proposed — confirm with leadership: Four values, each with the behaviour that shows it. A value without a behaviour is a slogan, so keep the behaviour line when you quote a value.

Value	What it means	How it shows up in our work
Show our working	Trust in climate data is earned through transparency.	We publish our methods, data sources, assumptions and uncertainty alongside every result.
Evidence before claims	We never claim more impact than the data supports.	We say "estimated", give ranges, and cite the source for every number we publish.
Clear for everyone	A result is only useful if the people who act on it can understand it.	We write a plain-language summary for every technical output, and we design to WCAG 2.2 AA.
Progress together	Climate action is shared work between cities, utilities, partners and residents.	We credit partners and customers accurately, and we share what we learn, including what did not work.

Audiences

Our four audiences have different expertise, but they share one need: evidence they can trust and act on. Write for the least specialist reader who will see the content, and offer more depth for those who want it.

Audience	Who they are	What they need from us	Main channels	Accessibility and inclusion needs to plan for
City sustainability officers	Public-sector staff who set and report on climate targets, often explaining results to elected members and residents	Clear findings they can reuse in council papers, honest uncertainty, and progress they can report	Website, LinkedIn, email, webinars, reports	Public bodies must meet accessibility regulations, so anything they republish must be accessible (tagged PDFs, alt text, plain-language summaries). Their own readers include residents with a wide range of reading levels and first languages.
Utility engineers	Technical staff who plan, operate and maintain networks and assets	Correct units, explicit methods, data definitions, and outputs that fit their tools	Product, documentation, technical notes, YouTube walkthroughs	Precise, scannable content. Engineers often read on site or on mobile, so tables must reflow and charts must not rely on colour alone.
Investors	Current and prospective funders assessing our business and its impact	Verifiable metrics, clear risks, and no overstated climate impact	Investor updates, website, LinkedIn, board packs	Accessible PDFs and slide decks, consistent figures across documents, and plain summaries of technical points.
Climate-tech partners	Organisations that integrate with, resell or co-deliver with us	Clear roles, accurate joint claims, integration detail and brand rules for co-branding	Partner pages, LinkedIn, X, events, documentation	Many partners read English as an additional language, so avoid idioms, sports metaphors and culturally specific references.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: We also treat **residents and elected members** as a secondary audience. They do not buy from us, but they read the reports our customers publish, so our charts and summaries must make sense to them too.

Personality

The organisation chose three personality traits. Each one drives a voice attribute in chapter 11.

Trait	What it looks like	Linked voice attribute
Confident	We state findings directly and stand behind our methods. The heavy wordmark and upward peak in our logo carry this.	Confident, never arrogant
Precise	We use the right number, the right unit and the right level of certainty. The logo's sharp geometric apexes carry this.	Precise, never pedantic
Optimistic	We focus on what can be done and the progress that is possible, without hiding risk. The warm Daybreak Amber peak carries this.	Optimistic, never hyped

Proposed — confirm with leadership: A fourth voice attribute, **Clear**, supports all three traits and our accessibility commitment. It is listed in chapter 11 as a voice attribute rather than a personality trait.

Tagline

Proposed — confirm with leadership: **Clear data for climate decisions.**

Alternatives for leadership to consider: "Climate data, made clear." and "See the evidence. Make the call."

Warning Run a trademark and domain search before adopting any tagline. Do not use a tagline that promises an outcome we cannot prove, such as "Cutting city emissions".

Boilerplate

Use the boilerplate at the end of press releases, partner announcements, event listings and profiles. Copy it exactly, and choose the length that fits the space.

Note These drafts contain no facts about our history, customers or results because none were supplied. Add verified facts (for example, the year we were founded or where we are based) only after leadership confirms them.

Short (about 25 words)

Proposed — confirm with leadership: Northwind Labs turns climate data into clear, decision-ready evidence for city governments and utilities, so they can plan, invest and act with confidence.

Medium (about 50 words)

Proposed — confirm with leadership: Northwind Labs is a climate data analytics company working with city governments and utilities. We turn complex climate and energy data into clear evidence that sustainability officers, engineers and investors can act on. We show our methods and our uncertainty, so every decision rests on evidence people can check.

Long (about 100 words)

Proposed — confirm with leadership: Northwind Labs is a climate data analytics company working with city governments and utilities. Cities and utilities face long-term, high-stakes decisions about energy, infrastructure and emissions, often with complex and incomplete data. We turn that data into clear, decision-ready evidence that sustainability officers, utility engineers, investors and partners can understand and act on. We show our methods, our assumptions and our uncertainty, so every result can be checked and explained to the people it affects. We believe better evidence leads to better climate decisions. To find out more, email hello@northwindlabs.example.

Do check that the data domains in the boilerplate (climate, energy, emissions, infrastructure) match what our products actually cover before publishing.

Don't add customer names, savings figures, emissions reductions or awards to the boilerplate unless they are verified, current and approved for public use.

Accessibility When the boilerplate appears in a PDF or slide, keep it as live text, not an image, so screen readers and translation tools can read it.

Logo

Our logo is the fastest way city teams, utilities, investors and partners recognise Northwind Labs. Using it the same way every time builds trust, and that matters when people rely on our data for public decisions.

Our logo

The Northwind Labs logo is a **combination mark**: a symbol and a wordmark that always appear in a fixed relationship.

- **The symbol** is a Fjord Teal circle holding an open Daybreak Amber peak, an upward-pointing chevron with its base cut away.
- **The wordmark** is "Northwind" in a heavy, geometric lowercase sans-serif in Polar Night, followed by "LABS" in small, widely spaced capitals in Fjord Teal.

The form sets the tone for the whole identity. Sharp apexes inside a soft circle become our mix of precise and approachable. The heavy wordmark carries our confidence. The upward peak points forward, which matches our optimism. The cool teal and navy are lifted by one warm accent. Our layout, icon, chart and motion rules all come from these cues.

Anatomy

Part	What it is	Can it be used alone?
Symbol	Teal circle with the amber open peak	Yes, as an avatar, favicon or app icon, or where space is square
Wordmark "Northwind"	Heavy lowercase name in Polar Night	No. Never separate it from the symbol
Descriptor "LABS"	Spaced capitals in Fjord Teal, on the wordmark's baseline	No. Never remove, move or resize it

The logo is wide, so it needs the symbol for square spaces. There is no tagline lock-up. If one is needed later, ask the Marketing team for designed artwork; do not set a tagline next to the logo yourself.

Versions and when to use each

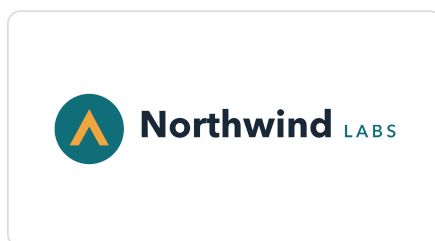
Use full colour wherever it passes. Use a single-colour version only when the background or the production method needs it.

Version	Use it for	File
Primary, full colour	Default on white and light neutral backgrounds: websites, documents, slides, reports	primary-full-colour
Symbol, full colour	Social avatars, favicons, app icons, small square spaces	symbol-full-colour
Single colour, dark (knockout)	Light backgrounds where colour is not possible, and Daybreak Amber backgrounds; one-colour print, engraving, fax and stamps	primary-mono-dark-knockout
Single colour, light (knockout)	Fjord Teal, Polar Night and dark backgrounds, and calm, dark areas of photographs	primary-mono-light-knockout

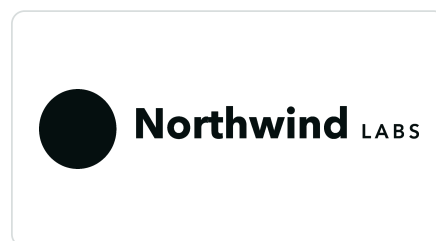
Our single-colour versions use the **knockout** style: the circle is solid and the peak is cut out, so the background shows through. We tested a plain single-colour fill, and the peak merged into a solid disc and the mark was lost. Always use the knockout files for single-colour work.



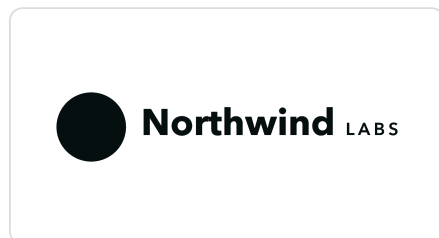
primary logo, full colour (PNG, transparent)



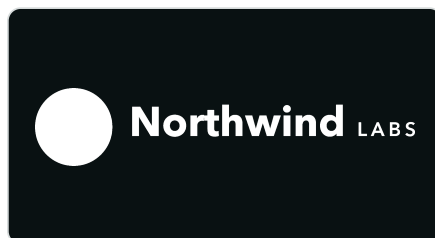
primary logo, full colour, with minimum clear space built in



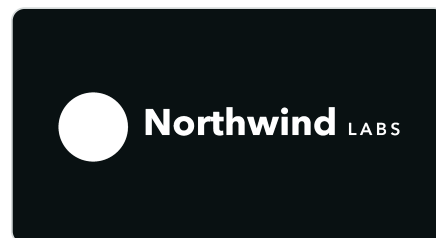
primary logo, mono dark (PNG, transparent)



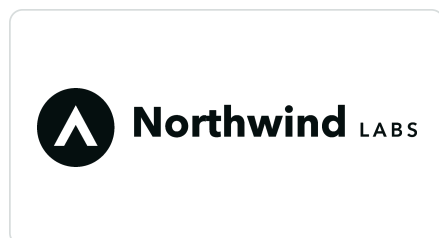
primary logo, mono dark, with minimum clear space built in



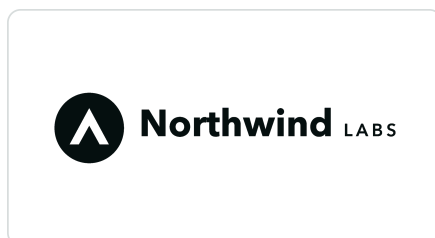
primary logo, mono light (PNG, transparent)



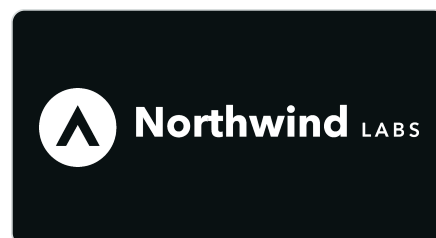
primary logo, mono light, with minimum clear space built in



primary logo, mono dark knockout (PNG, transparent)



primary logo, mono dark knockout, with minimum clear space built in



primary logo, mono light knockout (PNG, transparent)



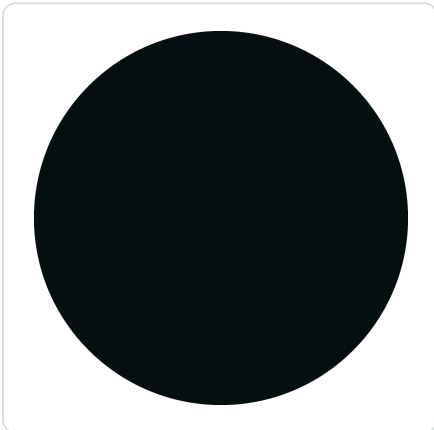
primary logo, mono light knockout,
with minimum clear space built in



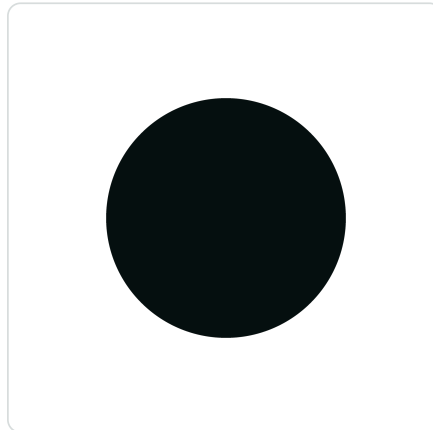
symbol logo, full colour (PNG,
transparent)



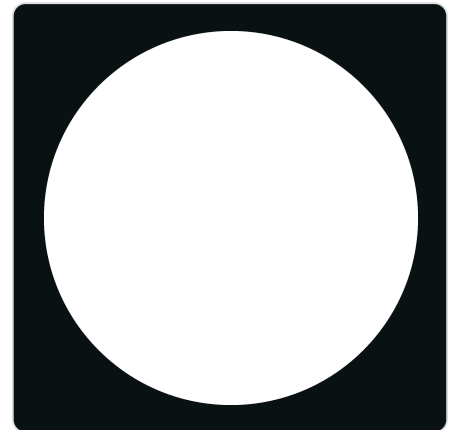
symbol logo, full colour, with minimum
clear space built in



symbol logo, mono dark (PNG,
transparent)



symbol logo, mono dark, with
minimum clear space built in



symbol logo, mono light (PNG,
transparent)



symbol logo, mono light, with
minimum clear space built in



symbol logo, mono dark knockout
(PNG, transparent)



symbol logo, mono dark knockout,
with minimum clear space built in



symbol logo, mono light knockout
(PNG, transparent)



symbol logo, mono light knockout,
with minimum clear space built in

Clear space

Keep an empty zone around the logo on all sides, measured with the height of the lowercase "o" in "Northwind". The exact fraction of the logo's height is in the specification table below. No text, image edge, other logo or page trim may enter this zone. The zone lets the bold wordmark hold its own and keeps the small "LABS" readable.

For the symbol on its own, use the same measure taken from the full logo at the size it would have been, or at least one-quarter of the circle's diameter, whichever is larger.

Logo specifications

Rule	Specification
Logo type	combination mark
Clear space	Keep clear space equal to the height of the lowercase 'o' in 'Northwind' (about 28% of the logo height) on all sides.
Minimum size (screen)	160 px wide
Minimum size (print)	34 mm wide
Symbol minimum size	24 px / 8 mm
Proportions	4.9 : 1 (width : height), wide-horizontal
Alt text	"Northwind Labs"

Minimum size

The screen and print minimums are in the table above. They are set so that "LABS", the smallest detail, stays readable. Below the full logo's minimum width, switch to the symbol. Below the symbol's minimum, do not use the logo at all. The one exception is the browser favicon, which uses the specially prepared files in chapter 14.

Placement

- **Web and apps:** top left in the header, aligned to the left margin of the grid in chapter 6, and linked to the home page.
- **Documents, reports and letterhead:** top left on the cover or first page. Repeat it only in the footer of later pages, at a smaller size.
- **Slides:** the full logo on title and end slides; the symbol, or nothing, on content slides.
- **Social and video:** the symbol as the avatar; the full logo on end cards, placed bottom right or centred.
- **Campaigns:** choose one corner per campaign and keep it the same on every asset.

Align the logo's left edge with the edge of the circle, not the clear-space box, so it lines up optically with the text below it.

Backgrounds

The table shows which version to use on each brand background, with the measured contrast. The logo must keep at least 3:1 against whatever is directly behind it.

		
On white (#ffffff): use full-colour (5.95:1). Full colour allowed (5.95:1).	On light-neutral (#f6f7f7): use full-colour (5.54:1). Full colour allowed (5.54:1).	On primary (#0f6e7a): use mono-light (5.95:1). Full colour not allowed (1.0:1).
		
On dark (#091112): use mono-light (19.08:1). Full colour not allowed (1.31:1).	On secondary (#1b2a3a): use mono-light (14.59:1). Full colour not allowed (1.0:1).	On accent (#f2a541): use mono-dark (9.3:1). Full colour not allowed (2.9:1).

Which logo version to use on each background (minimum 3:1)

Background	Use this version	Contrast	Full colour allowed?
☐ white	full-colour	5.95:1	Yes (5.95:1)
☐ light-neutral	full-colour	5.54:1	Yes (5.54:1)
☒ primary	mono-light	5.95:1	No (1.0:1)
☒ dark	mono-light	19.08:1	No (1.31:1)
☒ secondary	mono-light	14.59:1	No (1.0:1)
☒ accent	mono-dark	9.3:1	No (2.9:1)

- **White and light neutral:** full colour.
- **Fjord Teal:** light single-colour version. Full colour makes the circle disappear into the background.
- **Polar Night and dark neutral:** light single-colour version. Full colour loses the wordmark.
- **Daybreak Amber:** dark single-colour version. Full colour reaches only 2.9:1 here, just below 3:1, so we do not allow it.
- **Photographs:** place the logo only on a calm, even area, such as sky, water or a plain wall. Use the light version on dark areas and the dark version on light areas. If no area is calm enough, put the logo on a solid panel in a brand colour, with full clear space inside the panel.
- **Patterns and charts:** never place the logo over patterns, maps, charts or texture.

Do use the full-colour logo on white and light neutral backgrounds.

Don't use the full-colour logo on Daybreak Amber, Fjord Teal or Polar Night. Use the single-colour knockout version shown in the table.

Misuse

Never change the logo artwork. These rules protect it:

1. Don't stretch, squash or change its proportions.
2. Don't rotate or tilt the logo or the peak.
3. Don't recolour the logo, or any part of it, outside the approved versions.
4. Don't add effects such as shadows, glows, bevels, gradients or outlines.
5. Don't rearrange, resize or space out the symbol, "Northwind" or "LABS".
6. Don't place the logo on busy photos, patterns or low-contrast backgrounds.
7. Don't put the logo inside shapes, badges or frames that are not in this guide.
8. Don't use old, redrawn or traced versions. Download the current files.
9. Don't type "Northwind Labs" in another font next to the symbol in place of the wordmark.
10. Don't crop the logo or let it bleed off the edge of a page or screen.
11. Don't use the plain single-colour fill that hides the peak. Use the knockout version.
12. Don't turn the peak into an arrow, bullet or decorative pattern.

Warning Anything not covered here needs approval from the Marketing team before production.

Files and naming

Format	Use it for
SVG	Websites, apps, digital design tools
PDF or EPS (vector)	Print, signage, merchandise, embroidery briefs
PNG (transparent)	Office tools such as Word, PowerPoint and Google Slides, and email

Name exported files `northwind-labs-logo-{version}-{colour}.{ext}`, for example `northwind-labs-logo-primary-fullcolour.svg` or `northwind-labs-logo-symbol-light.png`. Never rename files with dates or "final". Use the version number in the download pack instead. All files are in the downloads section of chapter 20.

Note The current single-colour files are made automatically from the master artwork. For print, embroidery and signage, ask the Marketing team for the designer-drawn single-colour master.

Logo accessibility

- **Alt text:** use the alt text in the specification table. When the logo links to our home page, use "Northwind Labs home".
- **Never alone:** always state the organisation's name in page titles, document properties and running text. Never use an image of the logo in place of the name in a sentence.
- **Contrast:** the logo keeps at least 3:1 against its background on every use. This is our own rule, even though WCAG exempts logos.
- **Decorative repeats:** when the logo appears more than once on a page, for example in a footer, give the repeat empty alt text so screen readers do not announce it twice.

Colour

Colour is the first thing people notice about Northwind Labs, and in our charts and maps it carries data. Our palette has to look like us and stay readable for everyone, including people with colour-vision deficiencies who read our reports.

Our colours

All three brand colours come straight from the logo.

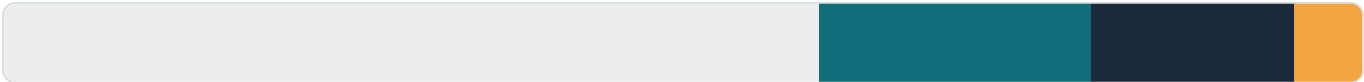
- **Fjord Teal (primary)** is the circle of our symbol and the "LABS" descriptor. It is cool, steady and technical. Use it for key actions, links, highlights and brand moments. Exact Fjord Teal passes 4.5:1 on white, so it works for text and buttons.
- **Polar Night (secondary)** is the colour of our wordmark. It is deep, serious and confident. Use it for headlines, dark sections, footers, covers and data-heavy dashboards.
- **Daybreak Amber (accent)** is the open peak in our symbol. It is the warm, optimistic spark in a cool palette. Use it in small amounts, such as a highlight bar, a key number, an illustration detail or one series in a chart.
- **Neutrals** are cool greys tinted towards Fjord Teal. They carry most text, backgrounds and borders.

Primary	Secondary	Accent
Fjord Teal HEX #0f6e7a RGB (15 110 122) HSL (187 78% 27%) oklch(49.4% 0.081 208.5) CMYK C88 M10 Y0 K52 (verify) Pantone: to be matched On white: 5.95:1 (AA) White text on it: 5.95:1 (AA) As text on white: use as is	Polar Night HEX #1b2a3a RGB (27 42 58) HSL (211 36% 17%) oklch(27.9% 0.036 250.8) CMYK C53 M28 Y0 K77 (verify) Pantone: to be matched On white: 14.59:1 (AAA) White text on it: 14.59:1 (AAA) As text on white: use as is	Daybreak Amber HEX #f2a541 RGB (242 165 65) HSL (34 87% 60%) oklch(78.0% 0.144 69.4) CMYK C0 M32 Y73 K5 (verify) Pantone: to be matched On white: 2.05:1 (Fail) Dark text on it: 9.30:1 (AAA) As text on white: use accent-600 #965d00

The swatches give HEX, RGB, HSL and OKLCH for screens and a CMYK starting point for print. CMYK values are mathematical conversions, not printer-tested values. Pantone references must be matched from a physical Pantone swatch book and confirmed on a printer's proof. Coated and uncoated stocks need separate matches.

Proportions

Most of what we make is calm and light, with colour used on purpose.



Approximate share of colour across a typical layout

☐ Neutrals and white 60% ☒ Fjord Teal 20% ☒ Polar Night 15% ☒ Daybreak Amber 5%

A typical report page is mostly white and light neutral with neutral body text. Fjord Teal appears in links, the section marker and the main chart series. Polar Night is used for headings and perhaps one dark data panel. Daybreak Amber appears once, for example as the bar that highlights the key finding. If amber is everywhere, it stops meaning "look here".

Tonal scales and tokens

Each colour has a scale from 50 (lightest) to 950 (darkest). Use the tokens, not eyedropped values.

- **50–200:** tinted backgrounds, table stripes, selected rows, map fills for low values.
- **300–500:** borders, icons, chart marks and UI on dark backgrounds.
- **600–950:** text, buttons and dark surfaces.

The exact logo colours are pinned into the scales: Fjord Teal is `primary-600` , Polar Night is `secondary-900` and Daybreak Amber is `accent-300` .

Fjord Teal tonal scale

Token	HEX	Contrast with white	Contrast with black	Text colour on it
☐ <code>primary-50</code>	#eff9fa	1.07:1 (Fail)	19.60:1 (AAA)	Dark
☐ <code>primary-100</code>	#ddf1f4	1.17:1 (Fail)	17.96:1 (AAA)	Dark
☐ <code>primary-200</code>	#bee2e8	1.38:1 (Fail)	15.23:1 (AAA)	Dark
☐ <code>primary-300</code>	#93ccd6	1.77:1 (Fail)	11.85:1 (AAA)	Dark
☐ <code>primary-400</code>	#63afbb	2.51:1 (Fail)	8.38:1 (AAA)	Dark
☒ <code>primary-500</code>	#3b94a1	3.54:1 (AA Large / UI)	5.94:1 (AA)	Dark
☒ <code>primary-600</code>	#0f6e7a	5.95:1 (AA)	3.53:1 (AA Large / UI)	White
☒ <code>primary-700</code>	#10606b	7.22:1 (AAA)	2.91:1 (Fail)	White
☒ <code>primary-800</code>	#054851	10.23:1 (AAA)	2.05:1 (Fail)	White
☒ <code>primary-900</code>	#003238	13.88:1 (AAA)	1.51:1 (Fail)	White
☒ <code>primary-950</code>	#001d21	17.53:1 (AAA)	1.20:1 (Fail)	White

Polar Night tonal scale

Token	HEX	Contrast with white	Contrast with black	Text colour on it
 secondary-50	#f3f7fc	1.08:1 (Fail)	19.52:1 (AAA)	Dark
 secondary-100	#e5eef7	1.17:1 (Fail)	17.90:1 (AAA)	Dark
 secondary-200	#cedded	1.38:1 (Fail)	15.19:1 (AAA)	Dark
 secondary-300	#adc4dd	1.79:1 (Fail)	11.72:1 (AAA)	Dark
 secondary-400	#88a5c4	2.55:1 (Fail)	8.23:1 (AAA)	Dark
 secondary-500	#6a89ab	3.63:1 (AA Large / UI)	5.78:1 (AA)	Dark
 secondary-600	#526e8d	5.28:1 (AA)	3.97:1 (AA Large / UI)	White
 secondary-700	#3f5872	7.37:1 (AAA)	2.85:1 (Fail)	White
 secondary-800	#2e4257	10.33:1 (AAA)	2.03:1 (Fail)	White
 secondary-900	#1b2a3a	14.59:1 (AAA)	1.44:1 (Fail)	White
 secondary-950	#0e1925	17.73:1 (AAA)	1.18:1 (Fail)	White

Daybreak Amber tonal scale

Token	HEX	Contrast with white	Contrast with black	Text colour on it
 accent-50	#fff5ea	1.08:1 (Fail)	19.50:1 (AAA)	Dark
 accent-100	#ffe9d1	1.18:1 (Fail)	17.83:1 (AAA)	Dark
 accent-200	#ffd29f	1.40:1 (Fail)	14.97:1 (AAA)	Dark
 accent-300	#f2a541	2.05:1 (Fail)	10.23:1 (AAA)	Dark
 accent-400	#de8d00	2.65:1 (Fail)	7.92:1 (AAA)	Dark
 accent-500	#b97500	3.75:1 (AA Large / UI)	5.61:1 (AA)	Dark
 accent-600	#965d00	5.44:1 (AA)	3.86:1 (AA Large / UI)	White
 accent-700	#774a00	7.60:1 (AAA)	2.76:1 (Fail)	White
 accent-800	#5b3700	10.55:1 (AAA)	1.99:1 (Fail)	White
 accent-900	#3f2500	14.23:1 (AAA)	1.48:1 (Fail)	White
 accent-950	#261400	17.76:1 (AAA)	1.18:1 (Fail)	White

Neutral tonal scale

Token	HEX	Contrast with white	Contrast with black	Text colour on it
 neutral-50	#f6f7f7	1.07:1 (Fail)	19.57:1 (AAA)	Dark
 neutral-100	#ebedee	1.17:1 (Fail)	17.88:1 (AAA)	Dark
 neutral-200	#d7dcdc	1.39:1 (Fail)	15.16:1 (AAA)	Dark
 neutral-300	#bbc2c4	1.81:1 (Fail)	11.63:1 (AAA)	Dark
 neutral-400	#9aa3a5	2.57:1 (Fail)	8.16:1 (AAA)	Dark
 neutral-500	#7e888a	3.64:1 (AA Large / UI)	5.78:1 (AA)	Dark
 neutral-600	#656e6f	5.23:1 (AA)	4.01:1 (AA Large / UI)	White
 neutral-700	#4f5758	7.40:1 (AAA)	2.84:1 (Fail)	White
 neutral-800	#3b4142	10.39:1 (AAA)	2.02:1 (Fail)	White
 neutral-900	#282c2d	14.11:1 (AAA)	1.49:1 (Fail)	White
 neutral-950	#091112	19.08:1 (AAA)	1.10:1 (Fail)	White

Accessible pairings

These are the only approved text and background combinations. Each one shows its contrast ratio and what it is approved for.

Approved colour pairings and WCAG 2.2 contrast

Sample	Use	Foreground	Background	Ratio	Approved for	Result
	Body text on light background	neutral-900 #282c2d	white #ffffff	14.11:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Secondary text / captions on light background	neutral-600 #656e6f	white #ffffff	5.23:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Body text on dark background	neutral-50 #f6f7f7	neutral-950 #091112	17.78:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Fjord Teal text and links on light background	primary-600 #0f6e7a	white #ffffff	5.95:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	White text on Fjord Teal buttons and banners	white #ffffff	primary-600 #0f6e7a	5.95:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Fjord Teal text and links on dark background	primary-500 #3b94a1	neutral-950 #091112	5.39:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Exact Fjord Teal on white (any text)	primary #0f6e7a	white #ffffff	5.95:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Text on exact Fjord Teal background	white #ffffff	primary #0f6e7a	5.95:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Polar Night text and links on light background	secondary-600 #526e8d	white #ffffff	5.28:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	White text on Polar Night buttons and banners	white #ffffff	secondary-600 #526e8d	5.28:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Polar Night text and links on dark background	secondary-500 #6a89ab	neutral-950 #091112	5.25:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Exact Polar Night on white (any text)	secondary #1b2a3a	white #ffffff	14.59:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Text on exact Polar Night background	white #ffffff	secondary #1b2a3a	14.59:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Daybreak Amber text and links on light background	accent-600 #965d00	white #ffffff	5.44:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	White text on Daybreak Amber buttons and banners	white #ffffff	accent-600 #965d00	5.44:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Daybreak Amber text and links on dark background	accent-500 #b97500	neutral-950 #091112	5.10:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓

Sample	Use	Foreground	Background	Ratio	Approved for	Result
	Exact Daybreak Amber on white (decorative only - not for text or meaningful graphics)	accent #f2a541	white #ffffff	2.05:1	Decorative only	Pass ✓
	Text on exact Daybreak Amber background	neutral-950 #091112	accent #f2a541	9.30:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Success message text on tinted background	success-600 #00823a	success-50 #eefbf0	4.63:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Warning message text on tinted background	warning-600 #916100	warning-50 #fff5e9	4.98:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Error message text on tinted background	error-600 #b33f38	error-50 #fff4f2	5.29:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Info message text on tinted background	info-600 #006ebe	info-50 #f1f8ff	4.93:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Polar Night text on Daybreak Amber	#1b2a3a #1b2a3a	#f2a541 #f2a541	7.11:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Daybreak Amber text on Polar Night	#f2a541 #f2a541	#1b2a3a #1b2a3a	7.11:1	Any text (4.5:1)	Pass ✓
	Chart: accent-500 on white	accent-500 #b97500	#ffffff #ffffff	3.75:1	UI and graphics (3:1)	Pass ✓
	Chart: secondary-500 on white	secondary-500 #6a89ab	#ffffff #ffffff	3.63:1	UI and graphics (3:1)	Pass ✓
	Chart: accent-400 on neutral-950	accent-400 #de8d00	neutral-950 #091112	7.19:1	UI and graphics (3:1)	Pass ✓
	Chart: secondary-300 on neutral-950	secondary-300 #adc4dd	neutral-950 #091112	10.65:1	UI and graphics (3:1)	Pass ✓

How to read it:

- **Text-safe (4.5:1 or more):** any size of text.
- **Large text and UI (3:1 or more):** text of 24px and above, or 18.66px bold, plus icons, borders and chart marks.
- **Decorative only:** shapes, fills and illustration with no meaning. Never use these for text, icons or data.

Daybreak Amber needs care

Exact Daybreak Amber is 2.05:1 on white. On light backgrounds it is **decorative or large-area only**: a background panel, an illustration fill, a highlight bar. For amber text or links on light backgrounds, use `accent-600` . For amber buttons with white text, also use `accent-600` . Text on an exact Daybreak Amber panel must be dark (`neutral-950`).

Never combine

- White text on exact Daybreak Amber.
- Exact Daybreak Amber text, icons or chart lines on white or light neutral.
- Fjord Teal text on Polar Night (2.45:1).
- Daybreak Amber text, icons or chart marks on Fjord Teal (2.9:1).
- Polar Night text on the dark neutral background.
- Mid-scale steps (300–500) of any colour as text on white.

State colours

Success, warning, error and info have their own scales, kept apart from the brand colours.

State colours (always pair with an icon and text)

State	Text / icon	Background	Border	Solid (white text)
Success	 <code>#00823a</code>	 <code>#eefbf0</code>	 <code>#20a04e</code>	 <code>#00823a</code>
Warning	 <code>#916100</code>	 <code>#fff5e9</code>	 <code>#b37900</code>	 <code>#916100</code>
Error	 <code>#b33f38</code>	 <code>#fff4f2</code>	 <code>#d5584f</code>	 <code>#b33f38</code>
Info	 <code>#006ebe</code>	 <code>#f1f8ff</code>	 <code>#2389e2</code>	 <code>#006ebe</code>

Every state message has **an icon, a text label and a colour**. For example, write "Error: enter a postcode" with an error icon, not just a red border.

Warning Daybreak Amber is close in hue to our warning colour. Never signal a warning by colour alone, and keep brand Daybreak Amber out of warning messages. Use the `warning-` tokens for warnings, and Daybreak Amber only for brand highlights.

Fjord Teal also sits close to the success and info colours for some readers. Do not use Fjord Teal styling on status messages.

Colour-vision deficiency

Colour-vision deficiency is common, especially among men, so some of our readers in every audience will see our colours differently. The table simulates our colours for the main types and lists pairs that some people may confuse.

How key colours appear with colour-vision deficiencies (simulated)

Colour	Typical vision	Protanopia	Deuteranopia	Tritanopia	Achromatopsia
Fjord Teal	 #0f6e7a	 #63697b	 #555f7a	 #007472	 #646464
Polar Night	 #1b2a3a	 #242b3b	 #20273a	 #0e2e2f	 #292929
Daybreak Amber	 #f2a541	 #bfaa34	 #d1bc43	 #ff9290	 #b5b5b5
Success	 #00823a	 #837634	 #766d40	 #007f72	 #707070
Warning	 #916100	 #726400	 #7e6f06	 #9f5452	 #6b6b6b
Error	 #b33f38	 #5e5736	 #7b7035	 #c4233e	 #666666
Info	 #006ebe	 #4474c1	 #2365bc	 #00818c	 #6c6c6c

Pairs that may be confused — never use these together as the only way to tell things apart:

- Fjord Teal and Success (tritanopia)
- Fjord Teal and Info (tritanopia)
- Success and Warning (protanopia)
- Success and Warning (deuteranopia)
- Success and Error (deuteranopia)
- Success and Info (tritanopia)
- Warning and Error (protanopia)
- Warning and Error (deuteranopia)

Pairs to watch, and the rule for each:

Pair	Who may confuse them	Rule
Fjord Teal and success	Tritanopia	Never use teal next to success states without a label
Fjord Teal and info	Tritanopia	Info messages always carry the info icon and the word "Info" or "Note"
Success and warning	Protanopia, deuteranopia	Different icons (tick vs triangle) and text labels
Success and error	Deuteranopia	Different icons (tick vs cross), text labels, and never green/red alone
Success and info	Tritanopia	Icons and labels
Warning and error	Protanopia, deuteranopia	Different icons and labels; in charts, use different lightness and patterns

In short: **never use colour alone to carry meaning**. Add a label, an icon, a pattern, a position or a clear difference in lightness.

Dark mode

Dark interfaces use the dark neutral (`neutral-950`) as the main surface, never pure black, because pure black makes bright text halo and tires the eyes. Polar Night (`secondary-900`) works as a raised panel or a branded dark section.

On light	On dark
Body text <code>neutral-900</code>	<code>neutral-50</code>
Fjord Teal text and links <code>primary-600</code>	<code>primary-500</code>
Polar Night text <code>secondary-600</code>	<code>secondary-500</code>
Daybreak Amber text <code>accent-600</code>	<code>accent-500</code> , or exact Daybreak Amber, which passes on dark
State text <code>{state}-600</code>	<code>{state}-500</code>

Inside brand-coloured sections, use the focus ring colour set for that section (chapter 13): white on Fjord Teal and Polar Night, dark on Daybreak Amber.

Colour in data visualisation

Charts follow a fixed series order: Fjord Teal first, then distinct lightness steps of Daybreak Amber and Polar Night. Every mark must reach at least 3:1 against its background. Label series directly and add patterns for print. Chapter 9 has the full palettes for categories, sequences, temperature anomalies and maps.

Print and other media

- **Print:** start from the CMYK values above, then approve a printed proof. Ask the printer to match Pantone references from a physical swatch book. Specify coated and uncoated separately.
- **Embroidery:** match thread colours to a physical swatch, and use the single-colour logo for small stitching.
- **Signage and paint:** match RAL or NCS references from physical samples under the light where the sign will hang.
- **Screens:** colours differ between uncalibrated screens. Judge colour on a calibrated display or a printed proof, never on a laptop alone.

Colour: do and don't

Do use `primary-600` (exact Fjord Teal) for links and primary buttons with white text.

Do keep Daybreak Amber to small, deliberate highlights, about one per page or slide.

Do pair every state colour with an icon and a text label.

Don't set text in exact Daybreak Amber on white. Use `accent-600` .

Don't use brand Daybreak Amber to signal a warning.

Don't use pure black for large dark backgrounds. Use neutral-950 or Polar Night.

Don't make your own tints with opacity. Use the scale steps so contrast stays predictable.

Typography

Our readers are often reading numbers that matter: emissions totals, heat-risk scores, grid loads. Our typography has to make those numbers clear first and express the brand second. It should feel as confident and precise as the logo's heavy, geometric wordmark.

Our typefaces

We use three free, open-licence families. Each has one job.

Role	Typeface	Weights we use	Why it fits
Display	Manrope	600, 700, 800	A geometric sans with a sturdy build, like the heavy lowercase of our wordmark. Its open shapes keep large headlines friendly, not cold
Body	Inter	400, 600, 700	Designed for screens, with a large x-height, open shapes and clear figures. It stays readable in dense dashboards and long reports
Data and code	JetBrains Mono	400, 600	Monospaced, with a clearly different 0 and O, and 1, l and I. Use it for identifiers, station codes, API examples and aligned data

Manrope and Inter are similar in spirit but not identical. This is deliberate: the display face gives character, and the body face gives comfort over long reading. We are not claiming that the wordmark is set in Manrope. The wordmark is artwork and must never be retyped.

Weights not to use: do not use Manrope below 600, or light and thin weights of any family. Thin strokes break up on low-quality projectors and in print. Use Inter 700 sparingly, for emphasis inside text and for table headers.

Typefaces

Role	Typeface	Weights	Fallback stack	Source	Licence
Display	Manrope	600, 700, 800	system-ui, -apple-system, 'Segoe UI', Roboto, 'Helvetica Neue', Arial, sans-serif	Google Fonts	SIL Open Font License 1.1
Body	Inter	400, 600, 700	system-ui, -apple-system, 'Segoe UI', Roboto, 'Helvetica Neue', Arial, sans-serif	Google Fonts	SIL Open Font License 1.1
Mono	JetBrains Mono	400, 600	ui-monospace, SFMono-Regular, Menlo, Consolas, monospace	Google Fonts	SIL Open Font License 1.1

Where to get them and the licence

All three families are on Google Fonts under the **SIL Open Font License 1.1**. You may use them free of charge for commercial work, including websites, apps, print, social media, video and broadcast. You may embed them in apps and PDFs. You may not sell the font files on their own.

- **Websites:** self-host the WOFF2 files with our site assets rather than loading them from a third-party server. This is faster and avoids sending visitor data to another company. Load only the weights listed above, and use `font-display: swap`.
- **Desktop:** download the families from Google Fonts and install them. Ask IT if you cannot install fonts yourself.
- **Agencies:** may download the fonts directly. There is no licence to transfer.

Fallbacks and substitutes

Fallback stacks are in the table above. They use each operating system's own sans-serif so text stays readable while the brand fonts load.

When the brand fonts are not available:

Where	Use
Microsoft Office, if fonts cannot be installed	Arial for headings and body
Google Docs and Slides	Manrope and Inter are available in the font menu. Use them
Email (HTML templates and signatures)	Arial, Helvetica, sans-serif
Code in documents	Consolas or Menlo

Never mix a substitute with a brand font in the same document. Use one or the other.

Type scale and hierarchy

The scale steps up by a ratio of 1.25 from the `body` size. Use the tokens; do not set sizes by eye.

Clear, confident, kind

display — 60px / 3.75rem, line height 1.1, weight 700, tracking -0.02em. Campaign headlines, hero banners (one per page)

Clear, confident, kind

h1 — 48px / 3rem, line height 1.15, weight 700, tracking -0.015em. Page titles

Clear, confident, kind

h2 — 36px / 2.25rem, line height 1.2, weight 700, tracking -0.01em. Section titles

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

h3 — 28px / 1.75rem, line height 1.25, weight 600, tracking 0. Sub-sections

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

h4 — 22px / 1.375rem, line height 1.3, weight 600, tracking 0. Card and component titles

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

body-lg — 20px / 1.25rem, line height 1.5, weight 400, tracking 0. Introductions and lead paragraphs

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

body — 16px / 1rem, line height 1.5, weight 400, tracking 0. Default body text (never smaller on screen)

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

small — 14px / 0.875rem, line height 1.5, weight 400, tracking 0.01em. Captions, metadata, legal (not for long passages)

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

label — 14px / 0.875rem, line height 1.4, weight 600, tracking 0.02em. Buttons, form labels, tags

The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy dog

code — 15px / 0.9375rem, line height 1.5, weight 400, tracking 0. Code, data, reference numbers

Type scale

Token	Size	Line height	Weight	Tracking	Family	Use
display	60px (3.75rem)	1.1	700	-0.02em	display	Campaign headlines, hero banners (one per page)
h1	48px (3rem)	1.15	700	-0.015em	display	Page titles
h2	36px (2.25rem)	1.2	700	-0.01em	display	Section titles
h3	28px (1.75rem)	1.25	600	0	display	Sub-sections
h4	22px (1.375rem)	1.3	600	0	body	Card and component titles
body-lg	20px (1.25rem)	1.5	400	0	body	Introductions and lead paragraphs
body	16px (1rem)	1.5	400	0	body	Default body text (never smaller on screen)
small	14px (0.875rem)	1.5	400	0.01em	body	Captions, metadata, legal (not for long passages)
label	14px (0.875rem)	1.4	600	0.02em	body	Buttons, form labels, tags
code	15px (0.9375rem)	1.5	400	0	mono	Code, data, reference numbers

How to build a page:

- Use **one** **h1** per page or document. It names the page.
- Never skip a level. An **h3** sits under an **h2**.
- Headings describe what follows ("Heat risk by ward, summer 2026"), not labels ("Results").
- Use **display** only for campaign headlines and hero banners, once per page.
- Use **body-lg** for the introduction under a page title.
- Use **small** for captions, sources and footnotes, never for paragraphs.
- Use **label** for buttons, form labels and tags.
- Use **code** (JetBrains Mono) for identifiers, units in tables when aligned, and code.

On screens narrower than 768px, **display**, **h1** and **h2** may step down one level in size (for example, **h1** set at the **h2** size), keeping their weight and order.

Readable text

- **Line length:** keep text between 45 and 75 characters per line, aiming for 66.
- **Line height:** at least 1.5 for body text, as set in the scale.
- **Paragraph spacing:** at least **space-4** between paragraphs. Do not indent first lines.
- **Alignment:** left-aligned, with a ragged right edge. Never justify text; it creates uneven gaps that slow down readers with dyslexia.

- **Capitals:** use sentence case for headings and buttons. Use all capitals only for short labels of three words or fewer, with added letter spacing.
- **Italics:** never set whole paragraphs in italics.

Minimum sizes

Medium	Minimum
Screen body text	The <code>body</code> token
Screen captions and metadata	The <code>small</code> token
Print body text	11pt (12pt for public-facing reports)
Print footnotes	8pt
Slides	24pt
Social images	Text at least 4% of the image height
Signage	See chapter 18

Emphasis

- Use **bold** (Inter 600 or 700) for emphasis.
- Use *italics* only for titles of publications and for introducing a technical term. Manrope has no italic, so never italicise headings.
- Underline only links.
- Never fake bold or italic with software effects or outlines.

Numbers

Numbers are our product, so set them carefully.

- Use **tabular figures** (`font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums`) in tables, dashboards and any column of numbers, so digits line up.
- Use lining figures everywhere else (Inter's default).
- Right-align numbers in tables and keep the same number of decimal places in a column.
- Put a non-breaking space between a number and its unit (12 °C, 450 MWh, 3.2 tCO₂e).
- Use true subscripts for chemical formulae such as CO₂, not a lowered "2".
- For date, time and number formats, follow chapter 12.

Languages

Our locale is British English. Manrope, Inter and JetBrains Mono all cover Latin-script European languages. Coverage of other scripts, such as Cyrillic, Greek and Vietnamese, differs between the three families, so check each family's language list on Google Fonts before setting any language other than English.

- **Right-to-left scripts** (for example Arabic or Hebrew): use a typeface designed for that script, chosen with a native-speaking designer. Mirror the alignment to the right. Never add letter spacing to Arabic.
- **Chinese, Japanese and Korean:** fall back to a matching system face (for example Noto Sans CJK) and increase line height.

- **Hyphenation:** turn automatic hyphenation off for headings. In body text, allow it only in narrow columns.

Typography accessibility

- Text must still work when it is resized to 200%, with nothing cut off or overlapping.
- Layouts must allow users to increase letter, word and line spacing without breaking.
- Never use images of text, except for the logo. Charts must have their labels in real text where possible.
- For readers with dyslexia, spacing, left alignment and short lines help more than any "special" font. Our rules above cover this.

Typography: do and don't

Do use tabular figures in every table and dashboard.

Do keep to two families on a page, plus JetBrains Mono only where data or code needs it.

Don't add letter spacing to body text.

Don't set long text in Manrope below 20px. Switch to Inter.

Don't retype the "Northwind Labs" wordmark in Manrope or any other font. Use the logo file.

Don't justify text or set paragraphs in all capitals.

Layout, grid and spacing

Our logo is built from exact geometry: a perfect circle and sharp, symmetrical angles. Our layouts follow the same idea. A strict grid, consistent spacing and generous white space make dense climate data feel calm, ordered and trustworthy.

Spacing

All spacing is a multiple of our 4px base unit. Use the `space-` tokens for padding, margins and gaps. Never use values in between.

	<code>space-0</code>	0px
	<code>space-1</code>	4px
■	<code>space-2</code>	8px
■	<code>space-3</code>	12px
■	<code>space-4</code>	16px
■	<code>space-5</code>	24px
■	<code>space-6</code>	32px
■	<code>space-7</code>	40px
■	<code>space-8</code>	48px
■	<code>space-9</code>	64px
■	<code>space-10</code>	80px
■	<code>space-11</code>	96px
■	<code>space-12</code>	128px

Spacing scale (base unit 4px)

Token	Pixels	rem
space-0	0px	0rem
space-1	4px	0.25rem
space-2	8px	0.5rem
space-3	12px	0.75rem
space-4	16px	1rem
space-5	24px	1.5rem
space-6	32px	2rem
space-7	40px	2.5rem
space-8	48px	3rem
space-9	64px	4rem
space-10	80px	5rem
space-11	96px	6rem
space-12	128px	8rem

How to choose a step:

Relationship	Tokens
Inside a component (icon to label, label to input)	space-1 to space-3
Between related items (list items, form fields, card content)	space-4 to space-5
Between groups (cards in a row, paragraphs to a chart)	space-6 to space-8
Between page sections	space-9 to space-12

The rule is simple: things that belong together sit closer together than things that do not. If two groups look equally spaced, readers cannot tell where one ends.

Grid

We use a column grid that changes with the screen width. Content never grows wider than the maximum content width, so lines of text and charts stay comfortable on large monitors.

Layout grid (maximum content width 1280px)

Breakpoint	Viewport	Columns	Gutter	Margin
Mobile	0px+	4	16px	16px
Tablet	768px+	8	24px	32px
Desktop	1024px+	12	24px	48px
Wide	1440px+	12	32px	80px

- **Text containers:** keep paragraphs to 45–75 characters per line. On desktop this is usually 6 to 8 of the 12 columns, never the full width.
- **Charts and maps:** may span the full content width, with their title and caption aligned to the same left edge as the text.
- **Dashboards:** use the 12-column grid with cards that span 3, 4, 6 or 12 columns. Keep the gutter between all cards the same.
- **Margins:** the outer margins in the table are minimums. Content, including the logo, never sits inside them.

Composition

- **Align to a strong left edge.** Headings, text, charts and the logo share one left edge. This echoes the clean geometry of the mark.
- **One focal point per view.** Each page, slide or post has one main message: a headline, a key number or a chart. Use Daybreak Amber for that one point at most.
- **Use white space as a material.** Leave space rather than adding boxes and dividers. A page that is about 40% empty usually reads better than a full one.
- **Hierarchy through size and weight,** not through extra colours.
- **Keep the logo and data separate.** Never place the logo inside a chart or map area.

Common formats

Format	Margins	Grid	Notes
Web page	Per the grid table	4, 8 or 12 columns	Logo top left in the header, aligned to the first column
A4 report (portrait)	20mm on all sides, 25mm at the binding edge	12 columns, 5mm gutter	Body text spans 8 columns; side notes and small charts use the other 4
US Letter	0.75in on all sides	12 columns	Same structure as A4
Slide (16:9)	At least 5% of the width on each side	12 columns	One idea per slide; see chapter 17
Social square (1:1)	At least 8% of the width on each side	4 columns	Keep text and the logo inside the platform safe zones in chapter 15

Corner radius

Our logo combines sharp apexes with a soft circle. We echo that with **small, crisp corners**: enough to feel considered, never bubbly.

Corner radius

Token	Value	Typical use
radius-none	0px	Tables, full-bleed images
radius-sm	2px	Inputs, tags
radius-md	4px	Buttons, cards
radius-lg	8px	Panels, modals
radius-xl	16px	Feature cards, media
radius-pill	fully rounded	Pills, avatars, toggles

- Use `radius-none` for tables, charts, maps and full-bleed images, so data edges stay exact.
- Use `radius-sm` for inputs and tags, and `radius-md` for buttons and cards.
- Use `radius-lg` for panels and dialogs, and `radius-xl` only for large feature cards and media.
- Use `radius-pill` only for avatars, toggles and status pills. The circle is our symbol, so we use full circles deliberately and sparingly.
- Nested shapes use a smaller radius than their container.

Elevation

We prefer flat surfaces separated by space and subtle borders. Shadows show that something is above the page, such as a menu or dialog, not decoration.

Elevation (shadows)

Token	Value	Use
shadow-0	none	Flat surfaces
shadow-1	0 1px 2px rgb(0 0 0 / 0.08), 0 1px 1px rgb(0 0 0 / 0.04)	Cards, raised buttons
shadow-2	0 4px 8px rgb(0 0 0 / 0.08), 0 2px 4px rgb(0 0 0 / 0.04)	Dropdowns, popovers
shadow-3	0 12px 24px rgb(0 0 0 / 0.10), 0 4px 8px rgb(0 0 0 / 0.05)	Modals, dialogs

- On dark surfaces, shadows are hard to see. Use a lighter surface step, such as Polar Night on the dark neutral, to show elevation.
- Never rely on a shadow alone to mark an interactive element. Interactive cards also need a `border-strong` outline or a clear label.

Layout accessibility

- **Reflow**: every page works at a width of 320 CSS px without horizontal scrolling, except for content that needs two dimensions, such as large data tables and maps. Give those their own

scroll area with a visible label.

- **Zoom:** text can be zoomed to 400% without horizontal scrolling and without loss of content.
- **Reading and focus order:** the order in the code matches the visual order. Do not use the grid to move content visually so that it reads in a different order.
- **Spacing overrides:** layouts must not break when users increase line height, letter spacing or word spacing.
- **Targets:** keep at least 24 × 24px for every interactive target, and 44 × 44px on touch screens, with at least `space-2` between neighbouring targets.

Layout: do and don't

Do use the `space-` tokens for every gap, and the grid for every layout.

Do keep text columns narrow, even on wide screens.

Don't round the corners of charts, maps or data tables.

Don't fill white space with decorative shapes or extra logos.

Don't use large radii or pill shapes for buttons and cards. They do not match our sharp, precise mark.

Iconography

Icons help busy city and utility teams find their way through our products and reports quickly. They work only if they are consistent, clear and backed by text, so one icon always means one thing.

Our icon style

Our icons are drawn the way our logo is drawn: simple geometry, straight lines and sharp, clean corners.

Property	Rule
Style	Outline (unfilled). A filled version is used only to show a selected or active state
Grid	24 × 24px, with 2px of padding on every side (a 20 × 20px live area)
Stroke	2px at 24px, scaled in proportion at other sizes
Corners and caps	Sharp corners and square or butt line ends, to match the logo's apexes
Detail	The fewest strokes that still read clearly. No perspective, no 3D, no gradients
Direction	Arrows and trend icons point up and to the right for growth or improvement, echoing the peak in our symbol

Recommended icon set

Use **Material Symbols, Sharp style**, set to outlined (fill 0), weight 400 and grade 0. It is published by Google under the **Apache License 2.0**, which allows commercial use and changes. Keep the licence notice with any icon files you ship in code.

We recommend it because:

- the Sharp style has square corners that match our logo;
- it includes many climate and energy icons, such as thermostat, water drop, bolt, solar power, wind power and CO₂;
- it is a variable font as well as SVG files, so weight and size stay consistent.

If you need an icon that is not in the set, a designer draws it on the same grid with the same stroke and corners, and the Marketing team approves it. Never mix icon sets on the same screen or page.

Note If your product already uses another open-licence set such as Lucide (ISC licence) or Tabler (MIT licence), you may keep it in that product only, provided you use it consistently and keep the 24px grid and 2px stroke. Their rounded line ends are a little softer than our ideal.

Sizes

Size	Use
16px	Inline with <code>small</code> text, table cells. Decorative or paired with a text label only
20px	Inline with <code>body</code> text, inside buttons and form fields
24px	Default: navigation, toolbars, standalone actions
32px	Feature lists, empty states, section markers in reports
48px and above	Illustrative use only, such as infographics and slides

Align icons to the text they sit next to: centre them on the line height, with `space-2` between icon and label.

Colour

- By default, icons use the same colour as the text next to them (`text-default` or `text-muted`).
- For brand emphasis, use Fjord Teal (`primary-600`) on light backgrounds and `primary-500` on dark backgrounds.
- Every meaningful icon must reach at least 3:1 against its background.
- Never draw icons in exact Daybreak Amber on white or light neutral; it is below 3:1. Use `accent-600` if an amber icon is needed.
- State icons use their state token (`success-fg` , `warning-fg` , `error-fg` , `info-fg`) and always sit next to a text label.
- Never use one icon in several colours to mean different things. Change the icon and the label, not just the colour.

Labels and accessible names

- **Visible labels first.** Pair icons with a short text label wherever there is room, especially in navigation and on actions with consequences, such as "Delete" or "Publish".
- **Icon-only buttons** need an accessible name that describes the action ("Download data as CSV", not "Download icon"). Show a tooltip with the same text on hover and focus.
- **Decorative icons**, such as an icon next to a heading that already says the same thing, are hidden from assistive technology (`aria-hidden="true"`).
- **Never use an icon alone for critical meaning**, such as an alert, a data-quality warning or a status. Always add text.
- **One meaning, one icon.** Keep a shared list of icon meanings in the design library. For example, the warning triangle is used only for warnings.

Target size

- Every interactive icon has a target of at least 24 × 24px, and 44 × 44px on touch screens, even if the drawn icon is smaller.
- Leave at least `space-2` between neighbouring icon buttons.
- Show focus with our standard focus ring (chapter 13) around the whole target, not just the icon.

Icons: do and don't

Do use outline icons from one set, on a 24px grid with a 2px stroke.

Do give every icon-only button an accessible name that describes the action.

Do use the same icon for the same meaning everywhere.

Don't use the logo's peak or circle as an icon, bullet or arrow.

Don't use an icon alone to show status, risk or a warning.

Don't mix filled and outline icons, or icons from different sets, on one screen.

Don't use emoji in place of icons in products, reports or slides.

Photography and illustration

Our images show what climate data is for: real cities, real infrastructure and the people who run them. They should feel as confident, precise and optimistic as our logo. They should be clear, well composed and hopeful without being naive.

Photography style

Subjects

- **Cities and infrastructure:** streets, rooftops, tree canopy, transit, substations, water treatment plants, wind and solar installations, flood defences.
- **People at work:** sustainability officers, engineers and field teams using data, in control rooms, on site or in meetings.
- **Climate in context:** heat, rain and wind shown through their effect on places, such as a shaded street or a drainage channel after rain. Never show disaster or suffering for effect.
- **Our work:** screens and printouts of our maps and dashboards in real use, with real (or approved sample) data.

Composition

- Use clear structure: strong lines, horizons and repeating forms, echoing the geometry of our logo.
- Look up. Low angles and rising lines (towers, turbines, stairs, a horizon at dawn) echo the upward peak in our symbol.
- Leave calm space, such as open sky, water or a plain wall, where text or the logo can sit.
- Use one clear subject per image.

Light and colour

- Natural, clean light: early morning and clear daylight are ideal. The warm light of daybreak is a natural link to Daybreak Amber.
- Grade images gently towards cool teal shadows and clean, neutral highlights. Keep skin tones, vegetation and sky natural.
- Avoid heavy filters, crushed blacks, oversaturation and strong vignettes.

People and representation

Our audiences and the communities they serve are diverse. Our images must show that honestly.

- Across a set of images, include a range of ages, ethnicities, genders, body types and disabilities.
- Show disabled people as active participants and decision-makers, such as an engineer who uses a wheelchair leading a site visit, not only as people being helped.
- Show women and under-represented groups in technical and senior roles, as a matter of course rather than as a statement.
- Avoid tokenism: one diverse face in an otherwise uniform set is not representation.
- Photograph real places, with permission, rather than generic skylines that could be anywhere.

What to avoid

- Staged stock clichés: handshakes, people pointing at blank screens, glowing globes, a green leaf in a hand, light bulbs with plants inside.
- Doom imagery: burning forests or flooded homes used for shock.
- Text, logos or numbers baked into photographs. Add text as live text so it can be translated, read by screen readers and kept accurate.
- Fake data on screens that could be mistaken for real results.

Text over images

Text placed directly on photographs is hard to read, because brightness changes across the image.

- Prefer placing text on a solid panel in a brand colour next to or over the image.
- If text must sit on the image, add a scrim, a gradient overlay in Polar Night, under the text area.
- Check contrast at the **lightest point** behind the text, not the average. Text must reach 4.5:1 (or 3:1 for large text) at that point.
- Apply the logo rules in chapter 3: the logo goes only on a calm area or a solid panel.

Illustration

Use illustration to explain things that photographs cannot, such as how a sensor network works, how heat moves through a city, or a process.

- **Style:** flat, geometric and diagrammatic. Build from circles, triangles and straight lines, like the logo.
- **Line weight:** 2px at the 24px icon scale, scaled in proportion, with sharp corners to match our icons.
- **Palette:** use the brand scales only. Neutrals and Fjord Teal carry most of the drawing; use Daybreak Amber for one focal detail; use Polar Night for structure and outlines.
- **Detail:** only the detail needed to explain the idea. No textures, gradients or 3D shading.
- **People:** simplified, with varied skin tones and body types, never using stereotype shorthand.
- **Meaningful lines and shapes** must reach 3:1 against their background.

Sourcing and rights

- Use our own commissioned photography first, then licensed stock from an approved library.
- Keep a record of every image's source, licence, expiry date, usage limits and credit line.
- Get signed model releases for identifiable people, and property releases for private buildings where required.
- Credit photographers where the licence requires it, in the format in chapter 20.
- Never take images from search engines or social media without written permission.

Alt text

Every meaningful image needs alt text. Write it for the purpose of the image, not its appearance.

- Say what the image tells the reader in this context, in about 125 characters or fewer.
- Do not start with "Image of" or "Photo of".
- Decorative images, such as a texture or a repeat of nearby text, get empty alt text so screen readers skip them.
- For images containing data, see chapter 9 for chart and map alt text.

Example: "Utility engineer checking flood sensor readings on a tablet beside a storm drain", not "Woman with tablet".

AI-generated imagery

- **Disclose it.** Label AI-generated or AI-altered images in the caption or credits, and follow each platform's labelling rules.
- **No real people** in realistic AI imagery without their written consent, and never public officials or customers.
- **No fake evidence.** Never use AI imagery to depict real places, events, climate impacts, infrastructure or data as if they were photographs.
- **Review every image** for bias, stereotypes and artefacts, such as distorted hands, wrong text or impossible structures, before use.
- **Check the terms** of the tool for commercial use and ownership. If in doubt, ask the Marketing team.

Imagery: do and don't

Do show real people and real places using climate data with confidence.

Do check text contrast at the lightest point of the image.

Do describe the purpose of each image in its alt text.

Don't use disaster imagery for shock value.

Don't bake text or numbers into photographs.

Don't present AI-generated images as real places, events or data.

Data visualisation

Charts and maps are our product. City officers and utility engineers make public decisions from them, and investors judge our rigour by them. Every chart we publish must be accurate, honest about uncertainty and readable by everyone, including people with colour-vision deficiencies, people using screen readers and people printing in black and white.

Principles

- 1. **Lead with the finding.** The chart title states what the reader should take away ("Night-time heat risk is highest in the eastern wards"). The subtitle says what is measured, where and when.
- 2. **Show the data honestly.** Bar axes start at zero, scales are labelled, and ranges and gaps are visible, never smoothed away.
- 3. **Never use colour alone.** Every colour has a direct label, a pattern, a shape or a position to back it up.
- 4. **Show uncertainty.** Estimates, models and projections always show their range.
- 5. **Give an alternative.** Every chart has alt text and a data table or downloadable data.

Categorical palette

Use these in order for series that are different categories, such as sectors, scenarios or districts. Every colour reaches at least 3:1 against its background. Neighbouring series are **not** guaranteed to differ in lightness, and some pairs look almost identical in greyscale, so every series also needs a direct label and its own line style, marker shape or pattern.

Order	On light backgrounds	On dark backgrounds
1	Fjord Teal primary-600	primary-500
2	accent-500 (dark amber)	accent-400
3	Polar Night secondary-900	secondary-300
4	secondary-500 (slate)	Exact Daybreak Amber, accent-300
Context, "other" or benchmark	neutral-500 , dashed or hatched	neutral-400 , dashed or hatched

- Use **four categories at most** in one chart. For more, group the smallest into "Other", or use small multiples (a grid of small charts with one series each).
- The context series is grey **and** dashed or hatched, because grey can be confused with series 4 (light) or series 1 (dark) by some readers.
- Exact Daybreak Amber is below 3:1 on white, so it is never a series colour on light backgrounds.
- Do not use the state colours (success, warning, error, info) as series colours. They mean status, not category.
- In stacked bars, pies and area charts, separate adjacent segments with a 1px line in the background colour. This keeps segments distinct even when two colours have similar lightness.

Sequential palettes

Use a sequential palette for a single quantity that goes from low to high, such as tree canopy cover, rainfall or energy demand. Use five steps (classes) by default and seven at most.

Palette	Steps, low to high	Use for
Fjord Teal	primary-100 , primary-300 , primary-500 , primary-700 , primary-900	Neutral or positive quantities: coverage, capacity, rainfall, population
Daybreak	accent-100 , accent-300 , accent-500 , accent-700 , accent-900	Quantities of pressure or heat: emissions, heat exposure, peak load

- Darker always means more. Do not reverse a palette.
- The lightest steps of the sequential palettes, and the light midpoint of the diverging palettes, are below 3:1 against white. Use them only as **area fills** in maps and heatmaps, where each area has an outline and the legend shows the number range for each step. Never use them for lines, points or bars.

Diverging palette and temperature

Use a diverging palette when values sit above and below a **meaningful midpoint**, such as a temperature anomaly against a baseline, change from last year, or performance against a target.

Far below			Near below	Midpoint	Near above	Far above		
primary-800	primary-600	primary-400	primary-300	neutral-50	accent-200	accent-400	accent-600	accent-800

We checked this palette under protanopia, deuteranopia and tritanopia and found no confusable steps. Teal-to-amber is a cool-to-warm scale that reads naturally for temperature.

Rules for temperature, emissions and other climate scales:

- **Never use a rainbow (spectral or "jet") scale.** Its bright bands create false boundaries, it has no natural order, and it fails for colour-vision deficiencies.
- **Never use red and green as the two ends.**
- **Name the midpoint.** State it in the legend: for example, "0 °C = average for [baseline period]". Always name the baseline period.
- **Keep it symmetrical.** Use the same number of steps and the same range on each side of the midpoint, unless the data is truly one-sided. If so, use a sequential palette instead.
- **Show absolute temperatures sequentially** (Daybreak palette). Use the diverging palette only for anomalies and changes.
- **Keep scales fixed** across a series of maps or charts that readers will compare, such as each month of a year.
- **Daybreak Amber is not a warning colour.** Warm steps mean "above the midpoint", not "danger". If a threshold matters, such as a heat-health alert level, mark it with a labelled line or outline, not a colour change alone.

Maps

- **Choropleths (shaded areas) show rates, not totals.** Normalise by population, area or households (for example, "tCO₂e per resident"). For totals, use proportional symbols (sized circles) on a muted base map.
- **Classes:** use 5 to 7 classes with round-number breaks, and state the classification method (equal interval, quantile or natural breaks) in the caption.

- **Boundaries:** outline every area in a 0.5–1px line in the background colour, or `neutral-500` where areas need to stand out from the background.
- **Base maps:** muted neutrals only (`neutral-50` to `neutral-200` for land, `primary-50` for water), so the data layer leads. Roads and labels in `neutral-600` .
- **No data:** show missing areas in `neutral-200` with a diagonal hatch and a "No data" entry in the legend. Never let missing data look like zero.
- **Labels:** name key areas directly on the map. Include a scale bar on any map used for distances, and use an equal-area projection when comparing regions by size.
- **Interactive maps:** every value must also be reachable without a mouse, for example through a sortable table of areas below the map.

Uncertainty

Our users plan for ranges, not single numbers. Show them.

- **Confidence or prediction bands:** draw the central estimate as a solid 2px line, and the range as a fill in a light step of the same hue (`primary-200` for a Fjord Teal series). Label the band directly, for example "90% interval".
- **Projections:** draw observed data as a solid line and projected data as a dashed line, with a labelled vertical marker at the point where projection begins.
- **Scenarios:** name each scenario on the line, not only in a legend.
- **Estimates in bars:** use error bars, and hatch the bars for modelled or estimated values. Explain the hatching in a note.
- **Never** show a projection as a single line with no range, or crop a range so a trend looks more certain than it is.

Units, sources and numbers

- Put units in every axis title or label: °C, mm, MWh, tCO₂e. Use SI units and the formats in chapter 12.
- Say whether values are totals, per person, per area or percentages.
- Every chart has a source line in `small` text: data source, period and date of last update.
- Round to a sensible precision and keep the same number of decimal places across a chart.

Typography and structure in charts

- Use `Inter` for all chart text, at least 14px on screen (the `small` token), with tabular figures.
- Chart titles use `h4` . Axis titles and labels use `small` in `neutral-600` or darker.
- Gridlines are 1px in `neutral-200` (`border-subtle`): visible, but quieter than the data. Axis lines use `neutral-500` .
- Avoid 3D effects, dual axes, pie charts with more than five slices, and decorative backgrounds.
- Use `radius-none` on chart areas. A small radius on bar ends is not allowed, because it hides the exact value.

Accessible charts

- **Contrast:** lines, bars, points and outlines reach at least 3:1 against the background.
- **Direct labels:** label series at the end of lines or on bars, instead of relying on a colour legend. If a legend is unavoidable, put it above the chart in the same order as the data.
- **Patterns and shapes:** add hatching to bars and areas, and different marker shapes (circle, triangle, square) to lines, so charts work in greyscale print and for people with colour-vision deficiencies.

- **Alt text:** state the chart type, what it shows and the key takeaway. An illustrative pattern, not real data: "Line chart of average summer night temperature by district, [start year]–[end year]. All districts rise; the steepest rise is in [district]." Do not list every value.
- **Data table:** provide the data as an accessible table below the chart or as a CSV download. In reports, put it in an appendix and link to it.
- **Interactive charts:** tooltips open on keyboard focus as well as hover, and nothing is shown only on hover.

Charts: do and don't

Do use the categorical, sequential and diverging palettes in this chapter, by token name.

Do state the midpoint and baseline period on every anomaly map or chart.

Do show the uncertainty range for every estimate and projection.

Don't use rainbow or red–green scales.

Don't show raw totals on a choropleth map.

Don't use exact Daybreak Amber for lines, points or text on light backgrounds.

Motion

Motion helps people follow what changes on screen, such as a filter applied to a map or a panel opening. Used carelessly, it distracts, slows people down and can make some people unwell. Our motion is like our logo: precise, short and purposeful.

Principles

- **Purposeful.** Every animation explains something: where an item came from, what changed, or what to look at next. If it explains nothing, remove it.
- **Quick and precise.** Short durations and standard easing. Nothing bounces, wobbles or overshoots.
- **Consistent direction.** New content enters from the direction the user moved towards. Rising values and progress move upwards, echoing the peak in our symbol.
- **Data first.** When data updates, animate the change (for example, bars growing to their new length) so readers can see what moved. Never animate data in a way that misrepresents it, such as overshooting a value.

Tokens

Use the duration and easing tokens. Do not set times or curves by eye.

Motion tokens

Token	Value
duration-instant	0ms
duration-fast	120ms
duration-base	200ms
duration-slow	320ms
duration-deliberate	500ms
ease-standard	cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)
ease-enter	cubic-bezier(0, 0, 0, 1)
ease-exit	cubic-bezier(0.3, 0, 1, 1)

Reduced motion: When prefers-reduced-motion is set, replace movement with fades of 120ms or less, and stop parallax, auto-advancing carousels and looping animation.

Use	Duration	Easing
Hover and press feedback, colour changes, focus rings appearing	duration-fast	ease-standard
Small components: dropdowns, tooltips, toggles, accordions	duration-base	ease-enter to open, ease-exit to close
Panels, dialogs, drawers, chart and map updates	duration-slow	ease-enter to open, ease-exit to close
Page transitions and large chart transitions in presentations	duration-deliberate	ease-standard
Focus ring and essential state changes under reduced motion	duration-instant	—

- Exits are faster than entrances: people have already decided to move on.
- Never animate for longer than `duration-deliberate` in an interface. Longer animations belong only in video.
- Animate opacity and position (transform), not width, height or layout, so motion stays smooth.

Logo animation

The logo may be animated only in video intros, end cards and presentation title slides, using a version made or approved by the Marketing team.

- The animation lasts **3 seconds at most** and always **ends on the static, approved logo**.
- Movement comes from the logo's own geometry. For example, the circle draws in and the amber peak rises into place, then the wordmark fades in.
- Never stretch, rotate, bounce, morph, recolour or distort the logo, and never move the parts out of their final relationship for longer than the animation itself.
- The clear space and background rules in chapter 3 apply to every frame.
- Supply a static logo for anyone who has turned motion off.

Video intros and outros

- **Intro:** 3 seconds at most, or none at all on social video, where the first second must show the content.
- **Outro (end card):** the full logo on a brand-colour background, following the background table in chapter 3, held for 2 to 5 seconds, with the website address as live text.
- **Lower thirds:** Inter, on a solid Polar Night or Fjord Teal panel, entering with `ease-enter` and leaving with `ease-exit`.
- Video titles, captions and calls to action follow chapter 14.

Motion accessibility

- **Honour reduced motion.** When a user's device is set to `prefers-reduced-motion`, follow the reduced-motion rule under the motion tokens above: replace movement with short fades and stop parallax, auto-advancing carousels and loops. Design the reduced version first, then add motion.
- **No flashing.** Nothing flashes more than three times in any one second. Avoid large areas of rapidly alternating light and dark, including in video and animated charts.

- **Pause, stop or hide.** Anything that moves, blinks or scrolls automatically for more than 5 seconds, including carousels, animated charts, background video and live data tickers, has a visible pause control that works with a keyboard.
- **No autoplaying audio.** Video with sound starts muted or only when the user presses play.
- **Avoid vestibular triggers.** Do not use parallax scrolling, large zooms, spinning or full-screen slides, which can cause dizziness and nausea.
- **Captions.** Every video has accurate captions. Videos that explain data also need an audio description or a transcript that describes what the charts show.
- **Focus stays visible.** Animations never hide or delay the focus ring.

Motion: do and don't

Do use motion to show how data changed, with the duration tokens.

Do check every animation with reduced motion turned on.

Do end every logo animation on the static, approved logo within 3 seconds.

Don't use bounce, elastic or overshoot easing.

Don't autoplay looping animation or video without a pause control.

Don't spin, stretch or morph the logo.

Voice and tone

Our voice is who we are in words, and it stays the same everywhere. Our tone is how we adjust that voice to the moment: a product error, a council report and an investor update all sound like Northwind Labs, but they do not sound identical. Climate data is only useful if people trust it, and people trust organisations that are clear about what they know, what they do not know and what to do next.

Our voice must work for two kinds of reader at once: technical readers, such as utility engineers, who need exact units, methods and definitions; and policy and investor readers, who need the finding, the confidence level and the decision it supports. When in doubt, lead with the plain-language finding and put the technical detail directly underneath it.

Voice attributes

The first three attributes come from the personality the organisation chose (see chapter 2). *Proposed — confirm with leadership*: the fourth, Clear, holds the other three together and carries our accessibility commitment.

Confident

We are	We are not
Direct. We lead with the finding and stand behind our methods.	Arrogant, dismissive of other approaches, or certain where the data is not.
Calm and specific when things go wrong.	Defensive, vague or evasive.

Example: "Peak demand on this feeder is likely to exceed its rating within five years. Here is the evidence and what you can do about it."

Precise

We are	We are not
Exact about numbers, units, dates, sources and uncertainty.	Pedantic, or so caveated that the point disappears.
Careful to say "estimated", "modelled" or "measured", and to mean it.	Loose with words like "proven", "guaranteed" or "zero".

Example: "We estimate the programme avoided 1,800 to 2,300 tCO₂e in 2025 (central estimate 2,050 tCO₂e). The methodology note explains how."

Optimistic

We are	We are not
Focused on progress and on the practical steps that are possible now.	Hyped, utopian, or promising to "solve" climate change.
Honest about risk, and constructive about what to do with it.	Doom-laden, alarmist or fear-driven.

Example: "The gap to your 2030 target is real, and it is closing. These three measures would make the biggest difference."

Clear

We are	We are not
Plain, structured and easy to scan, with the most important point first.	Jargon-heavy, acronym-heavy, or written only for specialists.
Respectful of every reader's time, expertise and ability.	Patronising or over-simplified to the point of being wrong.

Example: "This map shows which streets are most likely to flood in heavy rain. Darker areas and the hatched pattern show higher risk."

- Do** state the finding, the confidence and the next step, in that order.
- Don't** borrow hype from the wider tech industry. Words like "revolutionary", "game-changing" and "AI-powered magic" undermine the precision people buy from us.

Tone by context

Use the dial to set tone. Formality runs from 1 (conversational) to 5 (formal). Seriousness runs from 1 (light) to 5 (serious). Our voice never goes below 2 on either dial in external content: we are never flippant about climate impacts, people's jobs or public money.

Context	Formality	Seriousness	Example	Words and habits to avoid
Marketing and campaigns	2	3	"Know where your grid will be under pressure, before it is."	Superlatives, "world-leading", "solve climate change", unsupported numbers
Website	3	3	"We help utilities see where demand is growing and why."	Jargon in headings, vague benefit claims, "click here"
Product and UI microcopy	2	2	Button: "Export as CSV". Empty state: "No sites yet. Add a site to see its emissions profile."	"Oops", "Whoops", blame, humour in data views
Customer support	2	3	"Thanks for flagging this. You are right that the totals do not match. We are checking the source data and will reply by 4pm today."	"Unfortunately", "as per my last email", "user error"
Error messages	2	3	"We could not load the 2024 data. Check your connection and try again. Your saved work is safe."	"Fatal", "illegal", "invalid user", codes without explanation
Data reports and methodology	4	4	"Emissions fell by an estimated 6% (range 4% to 8%) compared with 2024, mainly because of lower grid carbon intensity."	"Proves", "guarantees", false precision, unexplained acronyms
Bad news and crisis	4	5	"On 2 October 2026 we found an error in our heat-risk model that affected reports issued since June. We have corrected it and are contacting every affected customer today."	Minimising, passive voice that hides responsibility, speculation, humour
Social posts	2	3	"Heatwaves put pressure on city grids. Our new guide explains how to plan for peak demand. Link in comments."	Hashtag stuffing, emoji in the middle of sentences, engagement bait
Social replies and complaints	2	4	"Sorry this has been frustrating. We would like to look into it. Please email hello@northwindlabs.example and we will reply within one working day."	Arguing in public, copy-paste replies, sharing private details

Context	Formality	Seriousness	Example	Words and habits to avoid
Recruitment	2	3	"You will build models that city teams use to plan real infrastructure."	"Rockstar", "ninja", "young and dynamic", gendered terms
Investor relations	4	4	"Revenue for the half-year was £[X], up [Y]% on the same period last year. The main risks are set out on page [N]."	Forward-looking claims without caveats, impact claims without evidence, inconsistent figures
Legal and contracts	5	4	Plain English, defined terms and short clauses.	Unnecessary Latin, "herein", "hereinafter", hidden key terms
Internal communications	2	2	"Quick update: the new data pipeline is live. Tell us in the team channel if anything looks wrong."	In-jokes that exclude new staff, acronyms only one team knows

Note Example figures in this guide are illustrative. They are not Northwind Labs results and must not be reused as facts.

Accessibility Error messages must say what happened, why if known, and what to do next, and must be announced to assistive technology. Never rely on red text or an icon alone to show that something went wrong.

Talking about numbers and uncertainty

Our audiences make decisions with our numbers, so how we present certainty matters as much as the number itself.

- **Say how we know.** Use "measured", "modelled", "estimated" or "forecast" deliberately. They mean different things.
- **Give a range when we have one.** "An estimated 1,800 to 2,300 tCO₂e" is more honest and more useful than "2,047 tCO₂e".
- **Match precision to confidence.** Do not report more significant figures than the data supports. Round, and say you have rounded.
- **Name the baseline and period.** "Compared with 2019" or "between April and September 2026", never just "a 20% reduction".
- **Use calibrated words consistently.** Reserve "very likely" for strong evidence and "may" for weak evidence. Chapter 12 sets the exact terms.
- **Explain technical units once, in plain words.** "Tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent (tCO₂e), a single measure that combines different greenhouse gases."

Environmental claims and greenwashing

Greenwashing damages trust in us and in our customers. Our audiences include regulators' readers, investors and journalists, so treat every environmental claim as one that may be checked.

In the UK, the Competition and Markets Authority's (CMA) Green Claims Code sets out six principles for environmental claims. Claims must:

1. be truthful and accurate
2. be clear and unambiguous
3. not omit or hide important relevant information
4. make only fair and meaningful comparisons
5. consider the full life cycle of the product or service
6. be substantiated

Advertising claims must also follow the Advertising Standards Authority's rules. Investors and partners may have their own disclosure rules.

How we apply this:

- **Every impact claim needs evidence on file:** the data, method, period, scope and who checked it. If you cannot point to it, do not publish the claim.
- **Separate our impact from our customers' impact.** We provide analysis; a city or utility takes the action. Write "helped [customer] identify" rather than "we cut emissions by", unless the customer has approved the wording and the evidence supports it.
- **Avoid absolute claims** such as "carbon neutral", "zero emissions", "green" or "sustainable" without a defined scope, standard and evidence.
- **Be careful with equivalences.** Comparisons such as "the same as taking 500 cars off the road" must come from a cited, recognised source and use the same scope and period.
- **Get customer approval** before naming a customer or quoting their results.

Warning This section is editorial guidance, not legal advice. Ask a qualified adviser to review high-profile environmental claims, investor communications and anything published in a new country.

Before and after

These rewrites use typical Northwind Labs situations. The figures are illustrative.

Before	After	Why
"Our revolutionary AI platform will slash your city's emissions."	"Our analysis shows where emission cuts are most achievable, so you can focus budget where it counts."	Removes hype and an outcome we do not control; describes what we do.
"Emissions were reduced by 23.47% thanks to Northwind."	"Emissions fell by an estimated 21% to 26% compared with 2022. Northwind Labs analysis helped the council prioritise the measures behind this."	Matches precision to confidence, names the baseline and credits the customer's action.
"Error 503: Data ingestion failure."	"We could not import your meter data. The file may be too large. Try splitting it into files under 50 MB, or contact support."	Says what happened, a likely cause and what to do next.
"Utilising our proprietary methodology, stakeholders can leverage actionable insights."	"City teams and engineers can use our results to decide what to do next."	Plain words, a real audience and a real action.
"It's too late to stop climate change, but we can help you survive it."	"Some climate impacts are already locked in. Planning now reduces their cost and keeps services running."	Optimistic and honest, without fear-driven framing.
"Unfortunately, due to circumstances beyond our control, some reports may have been impacted."	"An error in our model affected flood-risk scores in reports issued between June and September. We have fixed it, and we will send corrected reports by 9 October 2026."	Takes responsibility, gives specifics and a date.
"Check out the green button on the right to grab your free report!!! 🌍🔥 "	"Download the free report on summer peak demand (PDF, 2 MB)."	Descriptive link, no directional cue, no emoji in a call to action.

Words we use and words we avoid

Use	Avoid	Why
estimated, modelled, measured, forecast	proven, guaranteed, exact (for estimates)	Shows how we know
reduce, cut (with a number and baseline)	slash, eliminate, solve	Avoids overclaiming
help, use, show, explain	leverage, utilise, empower, unlock	Plain language
city teams, engineers, residents	stakeholders (on its own), end users, the public (as a mass)	Names real people
climate risk, climate impacts	climate apocalypse, catastrophe (unless quoting)	Serious without alarmism
net zero, decarbonisation (with a defined target)	carbon neutral, eco-friendly, green (without evidence)	Green Claims Code
data shows, our analysis suggests	data proves, science says	Honest about evidence
gap, area we have not covered	blind spot	Avoids ableist metaphor
sample data, test data	dummy data	Avoids ableist metaphor
primary and replica, allowlist and blocklist	master and slave, whitelist and blacklist	Inclusive technical terms
person-hours, staffing	man-hours, manpower	Gender-neutral

Do read your draft aloud. If it sounds like a press release from an unnamed tech start-up, rewrite it until it sounds like a knowledgeable colleague.

Don't use fear, guilt or urgency without evidence to drive action. Our optimism is the reason people want to work with us.

Writing style

Consistent spelling, numbers and units make our work look precise and make it easier to trust. This matters more for Northwind Labs than for most organisations: a misplaced unit or an ambiguous date in a report can change an engineering decision or a council budget. These rules apply to everything we publish, from product labels to investor updates. Our house language is British English (en-GB).

When this chapter does not cover something, follow the GOV.UK style guide, which many of our public-sector readers already know. For scientific notation and units, follow the International System of Units (SI).

Our name

- Write **Northwind Labs** in full, with capital N and L, the first time it appears. After that, "Northwind Labs" or "we" are both fine.
- Never write "NWL", "Northwind" alone in formal text, "NorthWind", "northwind labs" or "NORTHWIND LABS". The logo sets "LABS" in capitals as a design detail. Do not copy that in text.
- The possessive is **Northwind Labs'** ("Northwind Labs' methodology"). Where that reads awkwardly, rephrase: "the Northwind Labs methodology" or "our methodology".
- Treat the name as singular in British English when it means the company: "Northwind Labs is", not "Northwind Labs are". Use "we" for the people.
- *Proposed — confirm with leadership:* Product and feature names follow the same rules. Capitalise them only once they are formally named and approved.

Spelling

Use British spelling with -ise endings.

Use	Not
organisation, prioritise, analyse, optimise	organization, prioritize, analyze, optimize
colour, behaviour, modelling, labelled	color, behavior, modeling, labeled
centre, metre (unit), litre	center, meter (unit), liter
programme (a plan of work), program (software)	program (for a plan of work)
licence (noun), license (verb)	license (noun)
decarbonisation	decarbonization

"Data" is singular in our general content ("the data shows"). In academic papers, follow the journal's style.

When you write for a US partner or audience, keep British spelling unless the partner's own guidelines require otherwise for co-branded material.

Grammar and punctuation

- **Active voice.** "We updated the model", not "The model was updated". Passive voice that hides who did something is never acceptable in a correction or apology.
- **Serial comma.** We do not use the serial (Oxford) comma by default ("energy, water and transport"). Add one when a list would otherwise be ambiguous.
- **Quotation marks.** Use single quotation marks, with double marks for a quote inside a quote: 'The officer said, "The map was clear," and approved the plan.' Put full stops outside the quotation marks unless the quote is a full sentence.
- **Dashes.** Use a spaced en dash (–) for an aside, sparingly. Use an unspaced en dash for ranges in tables (2025–2030). Use a hyphen for compound adjectives (a net-zero target, a long-term plan). The em dash in this guide's "Proposed — confirm with leadership" label is an editorial marker, not a style to copy.
- **Ampersands.** Write "and". Use "&" only in official names that include it.
- **Exclamation marks.** Avoid them. Never use more than one.
- **Contractions.** Use common contractions (we're, you'll, don't) in marketing, social and product copy. Avoid them in reports, legal text and investor material.

Capitalisation

- Use **sentence case** for headings, titles, buttons, menu items, labels, table headers, chart titles and email subject lines: "Download the summer demand report", not "Download The Summer Demand Report".
- Capitalise proper nouns, product names, programmes with official names and job titles only when they come before a name: "Head of Data Priya Shah" (illustrative name), but "our head of data".
- Write "net zero", "climate change", "the grid" and "the council" in lower case unless part of an official name.
- Never use ALL CAPS for emphasis in text. Some screen readers spell capitals letter by letter, and capitals are harder to read. Where a design calls for small capital labels, use CSS `text-transform` so the underlying text stays in sentence case.

Numbers

- Write one to nine in words and 10 and above as numerals: "three sites", "12 substations".
- Always use numerals for data, measurements, units, percentages, money, dates and times, even below 10: "4 MW", "3%", "£5".
- Use a comma for thousands: 1,000 and 24,500. Use a full stop for decimals: 2.5.
- Write "million" and "billion" in prose (£2.5 million, 1.2 million tonnes). In tables and charts you may use "m", "bn" and unit prefixes, with a key.
- Use the true minus sign (–) for negative numbers in typeset documents and charts. A hyphen is acceptable in CSV and code.
- Say **percentage points** when comparing two percentages: "Renewable share rose from 30% to 35%, an increase of 5 percentage points", not "5%".
- Start a sentence with a word, not a numeral: "Twelve sites" or rephrase.
- Ranges: "from 10 to 20" or "10 to 20" in prose; "10–20" in tables. Repeat the unit if it could be misread: "5 MW to 10 MW".

Uncertainty and precision

- Round to the precision the data supports, and say when figures are rounded. Do not write 12,437.6 tCO₂e if the uncertainty is about 10%; write "about 12,400 tCO₂e".
- Show ranges as "1,800 to 2,300 tCO₂e (central estimate 2,050 tCO₂e)". In technical documents you may add the interval type: "(90% confidence interval)".

- *Proposed — confirm with leadership:* Use these likelihood terms consistently, and define them in methodology notes.

Term	Use when the probability is about
virtually certain	over 99%
very likely	over 90%
likely	over 66%
about as likely as not	33% to 66%
unlikely	under 33%
very unlikely	under 10%

These bands follow the calibrated language used in climate science assessment reports, which many of our readers recognise.

Units and scientific notation

Our engineers need exact units. Our policy and investor readers need to know what those units mean. Do both.

- Use **metric (SI) units first**. *Proposed — confirm with leadership:* add imperial equivalents in brackets only for audiences that need them.
- Put a space between the number and the unit: 5 MW, 120 kWh, 20 °C. Use a non-breaking space so the number and unit stay on the same line. The exception is the per cent sign: 45%.
- Unit symbols are case-sensitive and never take an "s" for plurals: kW (not KW or kw), MWh (not Mwh), GWh, kV, tCO₂e (not tons CO₂).
- Do not confuse power and energy. **kW, MW and GW measure power** (a rate, such as a substation's capacity). **kWh, MWh and GWh measure energy** (an amount over time, such as a household's annual use).
- Write **tonnes**, not "tons". Use Mt for million tonnes (MtCO₂e) and kt for thousand tonnes.
- **CO₂ and tCO₂e** take a subscript 2. Use true subscript formatting in HTML, Word and slides. Where formatting is unavailable and the font supports it, use the subscript character (₂). On social platforms and in plain-text fields, write "CO2" and "tCO2e": platform fonts and screen readers handle subscript characters inconsistently.
- Write intensities with a solidus: gCO₂e/kWh, kWh/m².
- Explain each unit in plain words on first use in non-technical content: "tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent (tCO₂e), a single measure that combines the warming effect of different greenhouse gases".
- Name the emissions scope when it matters: "Scope 2 (purchased electricity) emissions", using the Greenhouse Gas Protocol's definitions.

Accessibility Screen readers may read "MW" as a word and "tCO₂e" as letters. In audio, video and alt text, write units out in full ("megawatts", "tonnes of CO₂ equivalent").

Dates and times

- Write dates as **day month year**: 2 October 2026. Use "Friday 2 October 2026" when the day matters. Do not use ordinals (2nd) or numeric dates (02/10/26) in prose, because they are read

differently in different countries.

- Date ranges: "2 to 6 October 2026" in prose, "2–6 Oct 2026" in tables.
- Financial and reporting years: "the 2026 to 2027 financial year" in prose, "2026/27" in tables. Always say which year type you mean (calendar, financial or a customer's reporting year).
- Times: use the 12-hour clock in general content (9am, 2:30pm, midday, midnight). Use the 24-hour clock with a time zone for operational schedules and incidents: 14:30 BST.
- In data files, APIs and logs, use ISO 8601 with a time zone: 2026-10-02T14:30:00Z. Say "UTC" or "local time" in every interface that shows timestamps.

Currency, phone numbers and addresses

- Use the symbol before the number with no space: £10, £10.50, €5. Do not add ".00" to whole amounts.
- When a document mixes currencies, use ISO codes in tables (GBP, EUR, USD) and say which exchange rate and date you used.
- Phone numbers use the international format with spaces: +44 20 7946 0000 (fictional example). Make phone numbers selectable links on mobile.
- Write addresses on separate lines with no commas at line ends, in the order the country's postal service uses. Do not abbreviate street names in body text.

Abbreviations and acronyms

- Spell out an acronym the first time you use it on a page, followed by the acronym in brackets: "greenhouse gas (GHG)". Then use the acronym.
- Do not define acronyms people already know better in short form, such as UK, PDF or CSV.
- Do not use full stops in acronyms or abbreviations: BST, UK, CSV.
- Write "for example", "that is" and "and so on" instead of "eg", "ie" and "etc" in prose, because some screen readers misread them.
- Limit each page or screen to a few acronyms. If you need more, add a glossary.

Links and calls to action

- Link text must make sense on its own and say where it goes: "Read the methodology note", not "click here" or "learn more".
- Start buttons with a verb and keep them short: "Export as CSV", "Book a demo", "Download the report".
- Say when a link opens a file, with its format and size: "Annual impact summary (PDF, 2 MB)".
- Do not open links in new tabs unless the user would lose work. If you must, say so in the link text.

Lists

- Introduce a list with a lead-in line that ends in a colon.
- Start each item with a capital letter only if it is a full sentence. Otherwise use lower case.
- Do not put semicolons or "and" at the end of items. Use a full stop only after full sentences.
- Use numbered lists for steps in order and bullets for everything else. Keep lists to about seven items.

Plain language

Plain language is how we make precise content usable by everyone, including people reading in a second language, people with cognitive or learning disabilities, and busy experts.

- **Reading age:** aim for a reading age of 9 to 11 for public-facing content such as the website, social posts and summaries written for residents. Technical documents may use technical terms, but still use plain sentence structure.
- **Sentence length:** average 15 to 20 words, and no sentence over 30 words. One idea per sentence.
- **Put the point first.** Every report, email and page opens with the finding or the action, then the detail.
- **Layer technical content.** Give a plain-language summary at the top, the detail below it, and the full method in a linked note.
- **Use common words.** "Use", not "utilise"; "help", not "facilitate"; "about", not "approximately"; "start", not "commence".

Inclusive language

- **Disability:** we follow the UK social model and say "disabled people", unless an individual or community tells us they prefer another term. Never use "suffers from", "wheelchair-bound", "the disabled" or "normal" as the opposite of disabled.
- **Ableist metaphors:** avoid "blind spot" (say "gap"), "falling on deaf ears" (say "being ignored"), "crippling costs" (say "severe costs"), "sanity check" (say "quick check") and "lame" or "crazy".
- **Gender:** use gender-neutral terms: "they", "everyone", "chair", "staff", "person-hours", "engineers" (not "linesmen" or "manpower").
- **Age:** do not describe people by age unless it is relevant to the data, such as "people over 75 are more vulnerable to heat".
- **Race, culture and place:** use the names communities use for themselves. Say "lower-income countries", not "third world". Avoid idioms, sports and military metaphors ("war on carbon", "moonshot", "hit it out of the park"), which exclude many readers and translate badly.
- **Climate impacts on people:** describe exposure, not weakness. Say "people most exposed to flooding", not "vulnerable populations", and "people displaced by climate-related disasters", not "climate refugees", which has a specific legal meaning. Do not imply that communities are to blame for the risks they face.
- **Technical terms:** use "primary and replica" and "allowlist and blocklist".

Accessible content

- Use meaningful headings in order (heading 1, then 2, then 3), so people can navigate with assistive technology.
- Never give instructions that depend on sight, colour or position alone. Write "Select Export", not "click the green button on the right".
- Describe charts in text: state the main finding in the title or caption, and offer the data as a table or CSV.
- Every meaningful image needs alt text that explains its purpose. Every video needs accurate captions, and audio needs a transcript.
- **Hashtags:** use CamelCase so screen readers read them as words (#ClimateData, not #climatedata). Use no more than three per post, at the end.
- **Emoji:** use sparingly, never more than one or two per post, never in place of words, and only at the end of a sentence. Screen readers announce each emoji by name.
- Never use "fancy" Unicode letters (bold or script characters from symbol blocks) on social. Screen readers cannot read them.

Do write "Peak demand rose by an estimated 8% (range 6% to 10%) between 2023 and 2025."

Don't write "Peak demand rose 8.137%!!" with no baseline, period or uncertainty.

Glossary of preferred spellings

Term	Notes
Northwind Labs	Never abbreviated
climate data analytics	Lower case
net zero, net-zero target	Two words as a noun, hyphenated as an adjective
decarbonisation	British spelling
tCO ₂ e	Tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent. Explain on first use
kW, MW, GW	Power (rate)
kWh, MWh, GWh	Energy (amount)
Scope 1, Scope 2, Scope 3	Capital S, numerals. Greenhouse Gas Protocol definitions
dataset	One word
real time, real-time data	Two words as a noun, hyphenated as an adjective
email, online, website	No hyphens
heatwave	One word
grid carbon intensity	Lower case. Give the unit (gCO ₂ e/kWh)

Accessibility

Our dashboards, reports and campaigns help city sustainability officers, utility engineers, investors and partners make decisions about climate risk. If someone cannot see a chart, use a keyboard, follow a video or read a PDF, they cannot act on our data, so accessibility is part of being precise, not an extra.

Our commitment

We design and build everything to **WCAG 2.2 Level AA**. This applies to every channel: websites, dashboards and apps, documents and PDFs, presentations, email, social media, video, print and events. Agencies, freelancers and partners working on Northwind Labs material must meet the same standard.

Working with public sector clients

Many of our clients are UK and European public bodies. Websites, apps and documents they publish are often covered by the Public Sector Bodies (Websites and Mobile Applications) Accessibility Regulations 2018 on [legislation.gov.uk](https://www.legislation.gov.uk)

(<https://www.legislation.gov.uk/uksi/2018/952/contents/made>), explained in the GOV.UK guidance on accessibility requirements for public sector websites and apps (<https://www.gov.uk/guidance/accessibility-requirements-for-public-sector-websites-and-apps>). Across the EU, procurement usually refers to the harmonised standard EN 301 549, which includes WCAG.

This guide is not legal advice. For each contract:

- Check the accessibility clauses in the tender or contract before design starts.
- Ask the client which standard and version they report against, and who maintains their accessibility statement.
- Give the client the information they need for that statement: what we tested, how, and any known issues with dates for fixing them.
- Refer legal questions to the client's accessibility lead or to legal advisers.

Accessibility If a client asks for a higher standard than this guide, the client's requirement wins. Never deliver to a lower one.

Colour and contrast

Contrast keeps text and data readable for people with low vision, on projectors and on phones in daylight.

What	Minimum contrast	WCAG 2.2
Body text, labels, table text (below 24px, or below 18.66px bold)	4.5:1	1.4.3
Large text (24px and above, or 18.66px bold and above)	3:1	1.4.3
Input borders, toggles, icons and other controls	3:1 against what is next to them	1.4.11
Chart lines, bars, map areas and other meaningful graphics	3:1 against the background, with a 1px background-colour gap between adjacent segments	1.4.11
Focus indicator	3:1 against adjacent colours	1.4.11, 2.4.7

Use the approved pairings in Chapter 4, Colour. They have already been checked. Key rules:

- Use Fjord Teal (`primary-600`) and Polar Night freely for text on white and light neutrals.
- Never use Daybreak Amber for text, icons or thin lines on white or light backgrounds. It fails contrast there. Use it for large decorative areas, or put Polar Night text on it. When you need amber text on a light background, use `accent-600` .
- Daybreak Amber is close in hue to our warning colour. Keep brand amber out of warning messages, and never use it alone to signal a problem.
- For text over photography or maps, use a solid panel or scrim and check the busiest part of the image, not the average.

Checking a new combination

1. Check the pairing in Chapter 4 first.
2. If it is not there, test it in any WCAG contrast checker, such as the WebAIM contrast checker or the Colour Contrast Analyser.
3. Brand team members can run `contrast_check.py` with `--use body` , `--use large` or `--use ui` , and `--cvd` to check colour-vision deficiency.
4. Ask the brand team to add any new approved pairing to the guide so others can reuse it.

Do check text contrast against the actual background it sits on, including tinted cards and image scrim.

Don't set captions, labels or links in Daybreak Amber on white, even at large sizes.

Never use colour alone

About 1 in 12 men and 1 in 200 women have a colour-vision deficiency. In our palette, these pairs can look alike (WCAG 2.2 SC 1.4.1):

- Fjord Teal with Success or Info (tritanopia).
- Success with Warning or Error, and Warning with Error (protanopia and deuteranopia).

So every meaning carried by colour also needs text, an icon, a pattern or a position.

- **Links:** underline links in body text. Colour alone does not count.
- **States:** pair success, warning, error and info colours with an icon and a word, for example "Error: enter a postcode".
- **Charts:** label series directly at the end of lines or on bars. Where series overlap, add line styles (solid, dashed, dotted) or fill patterns, and different marker shapes.
- **Maps:** label key areas, use patterns or hatching as well as fills, and show values in tooltips and a linked table.
- **RAG ratings:** write the status ("On track", "At risk", "Off track") next to every red, amber or green indicator.

Don't show a "good versus bad" comparison using only teal and green, or only green and red.

Accessible charts, dashboards and maps

Data products are our core work, so they must work for screen reader users, keyboard users and people with low vision or cognitive disabilities. Chapter 9, Data visualisation, sets the visual style. These rules make it accessible.

Every chart

- **Title that states the finding:** "Peak demand fell 12% after the retrofit" is better than "Peak demand 2020–2025". (Example only.)
- **Short alt text** naming the chart type and the key message, plus a **text summary** of two or three sentences next to the chart.
- **A data table** with the same numbers, either visible below the chart or one keyboard step away ("Show data table"). Tables need a caption and header cells (SC 1.3.1).
- **Contrast** of at least 3:1 for every line, bar, point and segment against the background, and gaps or borders between adjacent segments.
- **Direct labels** instead of, or as well as, a legend.
- Axis labels and tick text at least 14px (`small`), set in Inter or JetBrains Mono with tabular figures.
- Start bar charts at zero, and state units and the data source in text.

Interactive dashboards

- Every filter, tab, chart point and tooltip can be reached and used with a keyboard, in a logical order (SC 2.1.1, 2.4.3).
- Tooltips open on focus as well as hover, stay visible while the pointer is over them, and close with Esc (SC 1.4.13).
- Anything that needs dragging, such as range sliders or brushing, also has a single-pointer alternative, such as buttons or number inputs (SC 2.5.7).
- Targets are at least 24×24px, and 44×44px for touch (SC 2.5.8).
- Announce updates, such as "Showing 14 results", with a polite live region (SC 4.1.3).
- Live or auto-refreshing data has a pause control if it moves or updates automatically for more than 5 seconds (SC 2.2.2).
- Layouts reflow at 320px wide and at 400% zoom without losing content. Where a chart cannot reflow, the data table must (SC 1.4.10).
- Login screens do not depend on memorising or transcribing codes without an alternative, such as password managers and copy-paste (SC 3.3.8).

Maps

- Provide the same information outside the map: a sortable table or list by area, and a written summary of the main pattern.

- Zoom and pan with visible buttons and the keyboard, not only by dragging or scrolling.
- Do not trap keyboard focus inside the map. Give a "Skip map" link.
- Use sequential colour scales that change clearly in lightness, so they still work in greyscale.

Do ship every chart with a text summary and a data table.

Don't publish a chart or map as a flat image with no text alternative, in a dashboard, report or social post.

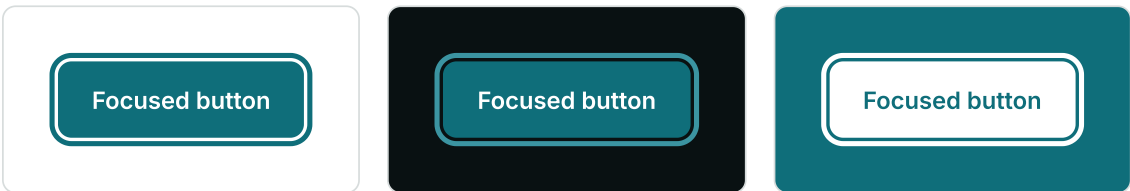
Typography

Medium	Minimum size	Notes
Web and apps: body	body (16px)	Never smaller for paragraphs
Web and apps: captions, metadata	small (14px)	Short, non-essential text only. Nothing below 12px
Print: body	11pt	12pt for reports to public bodies
Large-print versions	16pt	14pt is the absolute floor
Slides	24pt	18pt for footnotes and sources
Social images	Large enough to read on a phone without zooming	Repeat the text in the post

- Line height at least 1.5 for body text, with clear space between paragraphs.
- Lines of 45 to 75 characters.
- Left-align text. Never justify it, because uneven gaps slow down readers, including many dyslexic readers.
- Avoid long passages in capitals or italics. The spaced capitals in our logo are a logo feature, not a text style.
- Do not use Manrope or Inter below weight 400 for text.
- Text must resize to 200% and reflow at 320px without being cut off or overlapping (SC 1.4.4, 1.4.10), and survive users increasing letter, word and line spacing (SC 1.4.12).
- Use real text, not images of text, except for the logo (SC 1.4.5).

Focus and interaction

Keyboard users, switch users and many screen reader users rely on the focus indicator to know where they are. Our focus style is a solid Fjord Teal outline, offset from the element, with a lighter teal on dark surfaces and a contrasting colour inside brand-coloured sections:



Focus indicator

Property	Value	Check
Focus colour on light surfaces	 #0f6e7a	5.95:1 — Pass ✓
Focus colour on dark surfaces	 #3b94a1	5.39:1 — Pass ✓
Focus colour inside Fjord Teal sections	☐ #ffffff	5.95:1 — Pass ✓
Focus colour inside Polar Night sections	☐ #ffffff	5.28:1 — Pass ✓
Focus colour inside Daybreak Amber sections	 #091112	3.51:1 — Pass ✓
Outline width	3px	At least 2px (WCAG 2.4.13 guidance)
Offset from element	2px	

- Never remove the focus outline (`outline: none`) without replacing it with this style.
- Sticky headers, cookie banners and chat widgets must not cover the focused element (SC 2.4.11).
- Everything that works with a mouse works with a keyboard, with no keyboard traps (SC 2.1.1, 2.1.2).
- Buttons say what they do ("Download the report"). Links make sense out of context. Avoid "click here".
- Forms have visible labels, instructions before the field and errors described in text (SC 3.3.1, 3.3.2). Do not ask for the same information twice in one process (SC 3.3.7).
- Keep the help and contact link in the same place on every page (SC 3.2.6).

Do test every new component by tabbing through it before review.

Images and alt text

Alt text tells people who cannot see an image what it shows and why it is there (SC 1.1.1). Keep it to about 125 characters, and do not start with "Image of".

Type	What to write	Example
Informative	The content and why it matters	"Engineer checking a substation sensor on a frosty morning"
Functional (a link or button)	Where it goes or what it does	Logo linking home: "Northwind Labs home"
Decorative	Nothing: <code>alt=""</code> in HTML, and leave the platform field empty	Background texture, divider graphic
Complex (chart, map, infographic)	Short alt text plus a full text alternative nearby	"Line chart of city heat-risk days, 2015–2025. Full data in the table below."
Logo	The organisation's name	"Northwind Labs" ("Northwind Labs home" when it links to the home page)

Don't write keyword-stuffed alt text or repeat the caption word for word.

Video and audio

- **Captions** on every video, checked by a person for accuracy, names and technical terms. Edit automatic YouTube captions before publishing (SC 1.2.2).
- **Audio description** or a described transcript when visuals carry information that the narration does not, such as a chart appearing on screen (SC 1.2.5). Narrating the key numbers in the script avoids the need for a separate description track.
- **Transcripts** for podcasts, webinars and audio clips.
- **No autoplay with sound.** Autoplaying silent loops must have pause controls.
- For live webinars, provide live captions and share slides in an accessible format beforehand.

Motion and flashing

- Follow the reduced-motion rule in Chapter 10, Motion. When the user has turned on reduced motion, replace movement with short fades and stop parallax, carousels and looping animation.
- Nothing flashes more than three times per second (SC 2.3.1).
- Anything that moves, scrolls or auto-updates for more than 5 seconds has pause, stop or hide controls (SC 2.2.2). This includes animated chart transitions on loop and data tickers.

Documents and PDFs

Reports for public bodies are often republished on their websites, so they must be accessible from the start. Chapter 17, Presentations and documents, has the templates.

- Use the template's built-in heading, list and caption styles. Never fake headings with bold text.
- Set the document title and language (English, United Kingdom) in file properties.
- Give images and charts alt text, and add a data table or summary for every chart.
- Tables have a header row that repeats across pages. Avoid merged and empty cells.
- Check the reading order, especially for text boxes, sidebars and footnotes.
- Export **tagged PDFs** with bookmarks for documents over 10 pages, and check them with the Word or PowerPoint Accessibility Checker and then a PDF checker such as PAC or Adobe Acrobat's accessibility check.
- Where the client publishes online, offer an HTML version. Public bodies in the UK are encouraged to publish in HTML rather than PDF.

Do build the accessibility into the Word file. Fixing tags in a finished PDF takes much longer.

Social media

Chapter 15, Social media, has the full accessibility rules for each platform. In short:

- Write alt text in the platform's alt text field for every image, and repeat any on-image text in the post.
- Caption every video, and burn captions in for short clips that autoplay without sound.
- Write hashtags in CamelCase, such as #ClimateData, and put them at the end. The one exception is the disclosure label '#ad' or 'Ad', which goes at the start of the post.
- Use emoji sparingly, at the end of sentences, never in place of words.
- Never use "fancy" Unicode letters for bold or italics. Screen readers cannot read them.

Events and physical spaces

For workshops, conferences and stands, we:

- Publish step-free access, accessible toilets, parking and the nearest transport in the invitation.
- Ask every attendee about access needs when they register, and act on the answers.
- Offer, on request, large-print and digital copies of materials, live captioning (CART), sign language interpretation (BSL in the UK, or the national sign language elsewhere) and a hearing loop.
- Provide a quiet space and step-free routes to the stage and stands.
- Use signage that follows the contrast and size rules in Chapter 18.

Testing and sign-off

Automated tools find only part of the issues, so every release combines automated and manual checks.

1. **Automated:** run axe, WAVE or Lighthouse on every page or dashboard view, and the document checkers above.
2. **Keyboard:** complete every task with the keyboard only. Focus must stay visible and follow a logical order.
3. **Screen readers:** test with NVDA on Windows, VoiceOver on macOS and iOS, and TalkBack on Android.
4. **Zoom and reflow:** 200% and 400% zoom, a 320px-wide window, and increased text spacing.
5. **Colour:** greyscale and colour-vision simulations of charts and maps, plus Windows contrast themes.
6. **Content:** alt text, captions, headings, link text and plain language.
7. **People:** for products and major releases, include disabled people in user research and testing, and pay them for their time.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: the Marketing team signs off brand and communications material, and the product owner for each dashboard or app signs off digital products. Nothing is published or handed to a client with an open Critical or Serious accessibility issue.

Getting help and accessible formats

For accessibility questions, or to ask for any Northwind Labs material in another format (large print, accessible Word, plain text, Easy Read or audio), email hello@northwindlabs.example.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: we reply within 2 working days and agree a delivery date with the person who asked.

Digital and web

Most people meet Northwind Labs on a screen first: our website, a dashboard, a webinar or an email from a sales lead. Our public-sector clients must meet the UK Public Sector Bodies Accessibility Regulations 2018, so everything we put on a screen has to be as precise and accessible as the data we sell.

This chapter applies the logo (chapter 3), colour (chapter 4), typography (chapter 5), layout (chapter 6) and accessibility (chapter 13) rules to websites, product interfaces, email and video. Use token names from `tokens/tokens.css`, never typed colour values.

Website header and footer

Header

- Place the primary full-colour logo top left, on a white (`surface-default`) header. Align it to the first grid column and centre it vertically in the header bar.
- Set the logo at least 34px high (about 160px wide, the primary logo's minimum digital size in chapter 3) on desktop and mobile. If the space is narrower than that, use the symbol instead.
- On a Polar Night or Fjord Teal header, use the single-colour light (knockout) logo. Never place the full-colour logo on either: its teal circle disappears into the background.
- Link the logo to the home page. Give the image the alt text "Northwind Labs home", not "logo" and not the file name.
- Keep the logo's clear space (chapter 3) free of navigation items, search boxes and banners.

Footer

- Use a Polar Night (`surface-inverse`) footer with the single-colour light logo or the symbol, and `text-inverse` for links.
- Include: contact (hello@northwindlabs.example), an accessibility statement link, privacy and cookie notices, and the copyright line from chapter 20. Our public-sector clients will look for the accessibility statement first.

Do link the header logo home with the alt text "Northwind Labs home".

Don't use the full-colour logo on the Polar Night footer; use the single-colour light version.

Buttons and links

Element	Surface	Text	Notes
Primary button	surface-brand (Fjord Teal)	text-on-brand (white)	One per view: the main action
Secondary button	surface-default with a border-strong outline	text-link	For the alternative action
Tertiary / text button	None	text-link , underlined	Low-emphasis actions such as "Cancel"
Text link	Inherits	text-link , underlined	Underline always visible in body text

- Use the md radius (--radius-md) for buttons and inputs. Our corners stay tight to echo the sharp peak in the symbol.
- Buttons are at least 44px tall on touch screens and never smaller than 24 × 24px anywhere.
- Write button labels as verbs that describe the result: "Download the report", "Book a demo".
- Daybreak Amber is never a button colour with white text. If you need an amber highlight, use accent-600 with white text, or Polar Night text on exact Daybreak Amber.

Forms

- Every field has a visible label above it. Placeholder text is never the label.
- Field borders use border-strong so they reach 3:1 against the page.
- Mark required fields with the word "required", not only an asterisk.
- Show errors with an icon, a text message under the field (using the error fg token) and a summary at the top of the form that links to each field. Never rely on a red border alone.
- Keep the field's width related to the expected answer (a postcode field is short).

States

State	Treatment
Hover	Darken the surface one step (for example primary-700 for a primary button) and keep the underline on links
Focus	The brand focus ring defined in chapter 13: the focus token on light surfaces and focus-on-brand on brand-coloured ones, always outside the element
Active / pressed	Darken one further step
Disabled	Reduced-emphasis colours plus the disabled attribute, a "not-allowed" cursor and, where useful, a text hint explaining why
Selected	A check icon or bold weight in addition to colour

Accessibility Never remove the focus ring, and never make colour the only signal of a state. Disabled controls do not need to meet contrast, but they must still be readable and explained.

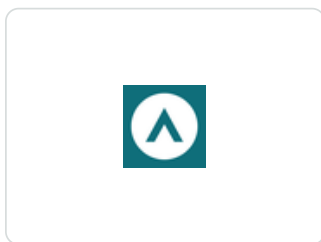
Dashboards and data products

Our product UI is where precision matters most.

- Use Inter for interface text and JetBrains Mono for values that people compare, copy or cross-check, such as meter IDs, coordinates and timestamps.
- Use tabular figures in tables and KPI tiles so digits line up.
- Follow chapter 9 for chart colours. Never encode status by colour alone: pair the success, warning and error colours with icons and labels. Daybreak Amber is a brand highlight, not a warning colour.
- Every chart has a text summary or a data table alternative.
- Content reflows at 320px wide, and tables scroll inside their own container, not the page.

Favicons and app icons

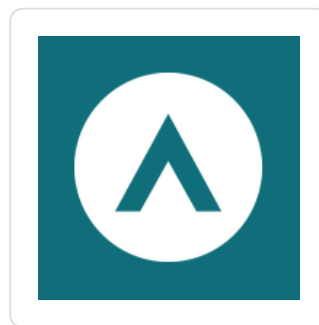
The favicon and app icons use the symbol only: the Fjord Teal circle with the Daybreak Amber peak. The wordmark is unreadable at these sizes. The maskable icon places the knockout symbol on a full Fjord Teal square, with the circle well inside the central safe zone, so Android can crop it to any shape without clipping the peak.



App/browser icon 48×48



App/browser icon 192×192



Apple touch icon 180×180
(opaque)



Android maskable icon
512×512 (content inside safe
circle)

```
<link rel="icon" href="/favicon.ico" sizes="48x48">
<link rel="icon" href="/icon-192.png" type="image/png" sizes="192x192">
<link rel="apple-touch-icon" href="/apple-touch-icon.png">
<link rel="manifest" href="/site.webmanifest">
<meta name="theme-color" content="#0f6e7a">
```

Copy every file from `assets/favicons/` to your web root and paste `assets/favicons/head-snippet.html` into the `<head>` of every page. It links `favicon.ico`, `icon-192.png`, `apple-touch-icon.png` and `site.webmanifest`, and sets the browser theme colour to Fjord Teal. The manifest also lists `icon-512.png` and `icon-maskable-512.png`.

Don't make a favicon from the full horizontal logo, or add a border or drop shadow to the icon.

Open Graph and link previews

- Use `assets/social/web/web-og-image-1200x630.png` as the default share image. It shows the single-colour light logo, centred on Polar Night.
- For individual pages, build a share image from the SVG template in the same folder: a short headline in Manrope, the logo bottom left, and all text inside the safe zone shown in the `guides.svg` file.
- Always set `og:title`, `og:description` and `og:image:alt`. The alt text describes the image's message, not "share image".

Email templates

- Width: 600px, single column, so it reads well on phones.
- Use live HTML text, not images of text. Body text is at least 16px with a line height of at least 1.5.
- Use Inter with the system fallback stack in chapter 5. Many email clients ignore web fonts, so the layout must still work in Arial.
- Buttons are bulletproof HTML buttons (not images), at least 44px tall, on `surface-brand` with `text-on-brand`.
- Logo: a transparent PNG at twice its displayed size, with at least 8px of padding around it and the alt text "Northwind Labs". In dark-mode email clients, a transparent full-colour logo can land on a dark background, so place it on a white header cell or use a version on a solid Polar Night panel with the single-colour light logo.
- Every image has alt text. The email must still make sense with images turned off.
- Include a plain-text version and a visible unsubscribe link for marketing emails.

Email signatures

Keep signatures short, consistent and useful.

```
[First name] [Last name] ([pronouns, optional])  
[Job title], Northwind Labs  
[Phone number]  
hello@northwindlabs.example | [Website]
```

- Text is live, in the default sans of the email client (Arial or the system font), at 14px or larger. Name in bold, title in `text-muted` colour.
- An optional small logo sits below the text: the full-colour primary logo, 160–200px wide when displayed, saved as a PNG at twice that size, with the alt text "Northwind Labs". A text-only signature is always acceptable.
- Never use an image-only signature: screen readers, plain-text clients and image blocking all lose it.
- No quotes, personal slogans, animated GIFs or banners. Campaign or event banners need approval from the Marketing team and must have alt text.

Video and webinars

Element	Rule
Title card	Polar Night background, single-colour light logo, title in Manrope, at least 2 seconds on screen
Lower thirds	Name in Manrope bold and role in Inter on a solid Polar Night bar, bottom left inside the title-safe area, on screen for at least 4 seconds
Captions	Accurate, human-checked captions (.srt or .vtt) on every video; burned-in captions on social cuts, in Inter on a semi-opaque dark box
End card	Logo, one call to action and the web address as text, at least 5 seconds
Thumbnails	Use <code>assets/social/youtube/youtube-thumbnail-1280x720.svg</code> ; a short headline of 5 words or fewer, a real image, the symbol in a corner; no clickbait
Webinar slides	Use the presentation template (chapter 17) and share slides in advance on request

- Logo animation, if used, lasts no more than 3 seconds and ends on the static logo. Follow chapter 10 for motion and reduced-motion rules.
- Provide a transcript for webinars and recorded talks. Public-sector clients often need one for their own records.

Do caption every video, including internal recordings shared with clients.

Don't put important information only in the audio or only on screen: say it and show it.

Social media

Social media is where most city sustainability officers, utility engineers, investors and partners first meet Northwind Labs, often in a feed, on a phone and with the sound off. Every post should look like us, be accurate enough to cite in a council report, and work for everyone, including people who use screen readers, captions or magnification.

This chapter covers our channels, profiles, post design, writing, accessibility, community management, crisis handling and governance. The Marketing team owns it. Send questions to hello@northwindlabs.example.

Channels and purpose

Each channel has one job. If a post does not fit the channel's job, do not post it there. Frequencies are guidance for planning, not a promise to followers.

Channel	Main job	Primary audience	Guide frequency
LinkedIn (primary)	Insight, case studies, webinars, hiring and partnerships	Sustainability officers, utility engineers, investors, partners	3–5 posts a week
X	Fast commentary on climate data, policy news and events; live updates at conferences	Journalists, policy specialists, the climate-tech community	3–7 posts a week, when there is something to add
YouTube	Webinars, product explainers, method walk-throughs, Shorts that point to them	Technical evaluators and procurement teams researching us	2–4 videos a month
Instagram	People, places and the visual side of climate data; behind the scenes	Future hires, partners, the wider public	1–3 posts a week plus Stories
Web (Open Graph)	Share image for every page and report link	Anyone sharing our links	Every published page

Note LinkedIn is our primary business-to-government and business-to-business channel. When time is short, publish on LinkedIn first and adapt for other channels afterwards.

Handles and naming

Use one handle pattern everywhere so people can find us and spot impostors.

- **Handle:** `@northwindlabs` on every platform. *Proposed — confirm with leadership:* this handle is an illustrative placeholder. Confirm that it is available and registered on each platform before you print it anywhere.
- **Display name:** "Northwind Labs" on every platform. Never add slogans, campaign names or emoji to the display name.
- **Sub-accounts:** do not open regional, product or team accounts without approval from the Marketing team. If one is approved, use `@northwindlabs` + a short suffix with no separator where the platform allows it (for example `@northwindlabsuk`), and the display name "Northwind

Labs + space + name" (for example "Northwind Labs UK"). Each sub-account needs a named owner and an entry in the account register.

- **Verification:** apply for platform verification on every official account where it is available, so that partners and city officials can tell us apart from copycats.

Bio templates

Write bios in plain language. Spell out acronyms. Put the most important words first, because bios are cut off in search results.

Platform	Field and limit	Template
LinkedIn	Tagline, 120 characters	"Climate data analytics for city governments and utilities." Then add the full company description in the About section.
X	Bio, 160 characters	"Climate data analytics for city governments and utilities. News, research and events from the Northwind Labs team."
Instagram	Bio, 150 characters	"Climate data analytics for cities and utilities. The people and places behind the numbers."
YouTube	Channel description, 1,000 characters	Two sentences on what we do, what the channel publishes and how often, then a link to the website and contact address.

Do link the bio to a page on our own website, such as a social landing page. You control it, it can be updated in minutes, and it is accessible.

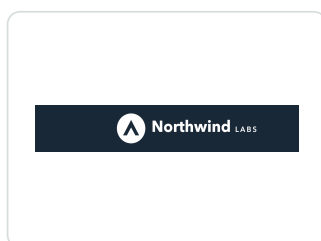
Don't use third-party link-in-bio services. They add tracking, often fail accessibility checks, and break when someone leaves.

Profile and cover images

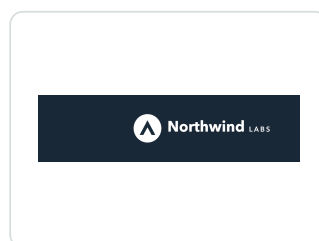
LinkedIn



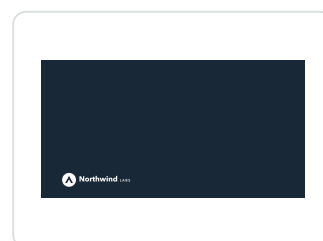
LinkedIn Company page logo (400×400)



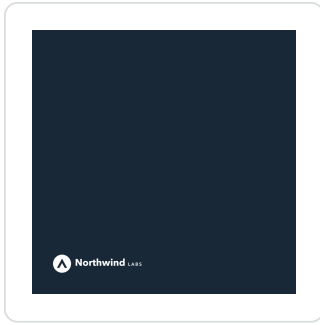
LinkedIn Company page cover (1512×256) — Displays at about 1128×191; keep the same ~6:1 ratio. Logo overlaps the lower-left on some layouts. Sources disagree on upload size (1512×256 vs 4200×700); verify on LinkedIn's Page image specs.



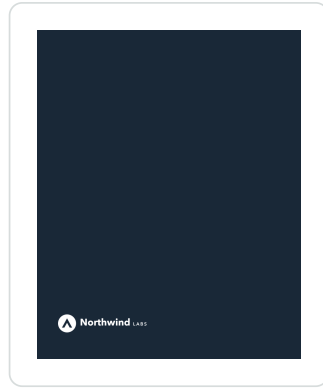
LinkedIn Employee profile banner (1584×396) — Profile photo overlaps the lower-left.



LinkedIn Post image (landscape) (1200×627) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template



LinkedIn Post image
(square) (1080×1080) layout
preview; add the headline
using the SVG template

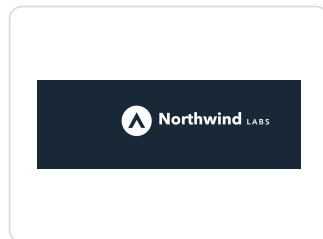


LinkedIn Post image
(portrait 4:5) (1080×1350)
layout preview; add the
headline using the SVG
template

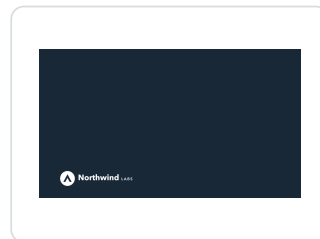
X (Twitter)



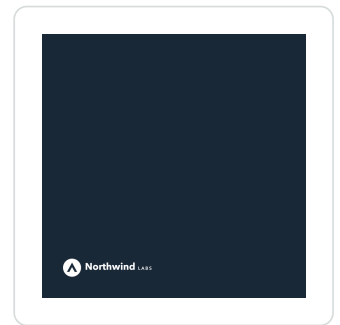
X (Twitter) Profile picture
(400×400) — Logo sized to
sit inside the circular crop.



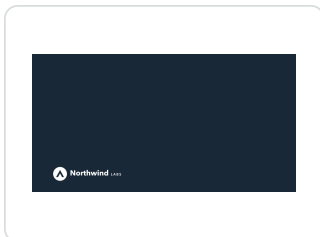
X (Twitter) Header
(1500×500) — Profile photo
overlaps lower-left; top and
bottom crop on some
devices.



X (Twitter) Post image (16:9)
(1600×900) layout preview;
add the headline using the
SVG template



X (Twitter) Post image
(square) (1080×1080) layout
preview; add the headline
using the SVG template

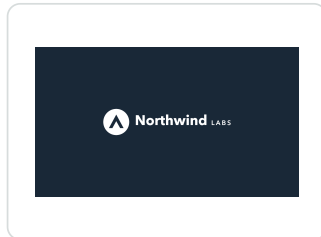


X (Twitter) Link card image
(1200×628) layout preview;
add the headline using the
SVG template

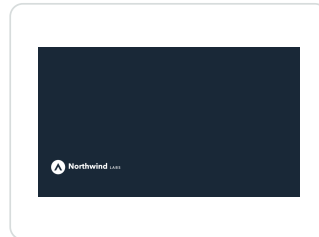
YouTube



YouTube Channel icon (800×800) — Logo sized to sit inside the circular crop.



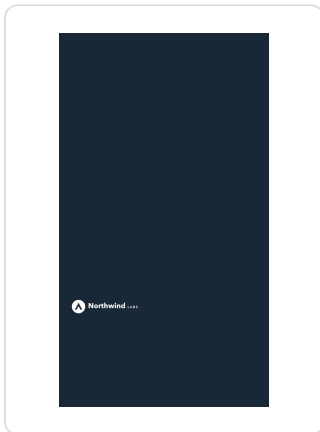
YouTube Channel banner (2560×1440) — Text and logo must sit inside the central 1546×423 safe area visible on all devices.



YouTube Video thumbnail (1280×720) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template — Duration badge covers the lower-right.



YouTube Video watermark (150×150)

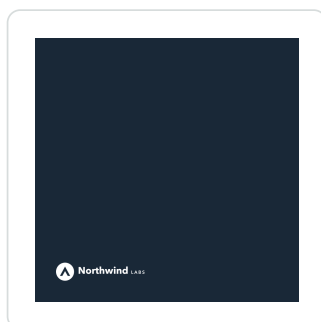


YouTube Short (1080×1920) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template

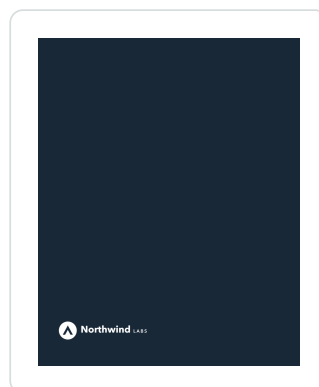
Instagram



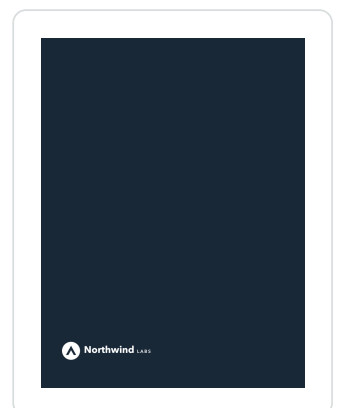
Instagram Profile picture (320×320) — Logo sized to sit inside the circular crop.



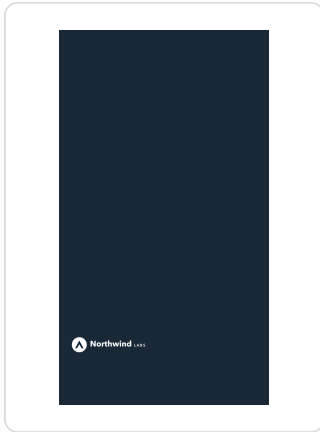
Instagram Feed post (square) (1080×1080) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template



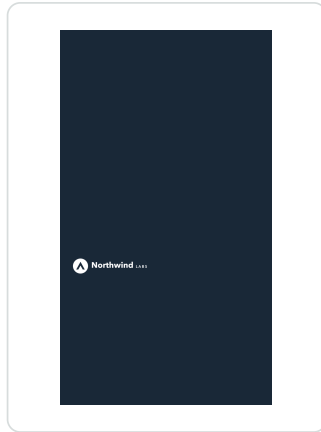
Instagram Feed post (portrait 4:5) (1080×1350) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template



Instagram Feed post (portrait 3:4) (1080×1440) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template — Profile grid previews crop to 3:4; keep key content central.

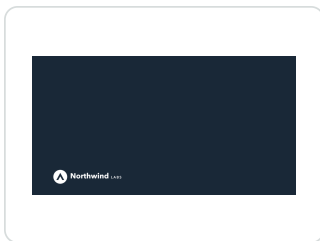


Instagram Story
(1080×1920) layout preview;
add the headline using the
SVG template



Instagram Reel / cover
(1080×1920) layout preview;
add the headline using the
SVG template — Reel cover
is cropped to 1:1 on the
profile grid and 3:4 in
previews.

Website sharing (Open Graph)



Website sharing (Open
Graph) Open Graph / social
share image (1200×630)
layout preview; add the
headline using the SVG
template

Each format also has an editable SVG template (with a hideable `guides` layer) and a `-guides.svg` safe-zone overlay in the same folder.

- **Avatar:** use the generated avatar for each platform. It shows the Northwind Labs symbol (the circle and peak) knocked out in white on Fjord Teal. We use the symbol rather than the full logo because the wide combination mark is too small to read inside a circular crop.
- **Covers and banners:** use the generated covers. They show the full logo in white on Polar Night, placed inside each platform's safe zone so profile photos and buttons do not cover it.
- **YouTube watermark:** use the 150 × 150 symbol file.
- **Open Graph:** every web page needs a share image (`og:image`) and matching alt text (`og:image:alt`).

Campaigns may change the cover image for up to eight weeks, using an approved template. Covers must still keep the logo or campaign text inside the safe zone and meet the contrast rules below.

Don't change the avatar for a campaign, cause or awareness day: no frames, overlays, colour changes or added text. People recognise us by the avatar, and changing it makes impostor accounts harder to spot.

Post design

Every format has an editable SVG template with a `guides` layer and a separate `-guides.svg` safe-zone overlay. Hide or delete the `guides` layer before you export.

Specifications last reviewed 2026-10-02. Platform specifications change frequently. Verify against each platform's help centre before publishing and update this file and the style guide's review date. Sizes are recommended upload sizes in pixels; safe zones are approximate insets (fractions of width/height) kept clear of platform UI and cropping.

Image sizes by platform

Platform	Format	Size	Ratio	Safe zone	Notes
Instagram	Profile picture	320 × 320 px	1:1	inside circular crop	
Instagram	Feed post (square)	1080 × 1080 px	1:1	8% margin	
Instagram	Feed post (portrait 4:5)	1080 × 1350 px	4:5	8% margin	
Instagram	Feed post (portrait 3:4)	1080 × 1440 px	3:4	8% margin	Profile grid previews crop to 3:4; keep key content central.
Instagram	Story	1080 × 1920 px	9:16	inset T14% R6% B14% L6%	
Instagram	Reel / cover	1080 × 1920 px	9:16	inset T14% R6% B35% L6%	Reel cover is cropped to 1:1 on the profile grid and 3:4 in previews.
LinkedIn	Company page logo	400 × 400 px	1:1	8% margin	
LinkedIn	Company page cover	1512 × 256 px	5.91:1	inset T10% R5% B10% L20%	Displays at about 1128×191; keep the same ~6:1 ratio. Logo overlaps the lower-left on some layouts. Sources disagree on upload size (1512×256 vs 4200×700); verify on LinkedIn's Page image specs.
LinkedIn	Employee profile banner	1584 × 396 px	4:1	inset T10% R5% B10% L30%	Profile photo overlaps the lower-left.
LinkedIn	Post image (landscape)	1200 × 627 px	1.91:1	8% margin	
LinkedIn	Post image (square)	1080 × 1080 px	1:1	8% margin	

Platform	Format	Size	Ratio	Safe zone	Notes
LinkedIn	Post image (portrait 4:5)	1080 × 1350 px	4:5	8% margin	
X (Twitter)	Profile picture	400 × 400 px	1:1	inside circular crop	
X (Twitter)	Header	1500 × 500 px	3:1	inset T12% R5% B20% L25%	Profile photo overlaps lower-left; top and bottom crop on some devices.
X (Twitter)	Post image (16:9)	1600 × 900 px	16:9	8% margin	
X (Twitter)	Post image (square)	1080 × 1080 px	1:1	8% margin	
X (Twitter)	Link card image	1200 × 628 px	1.91:1	8% margin	
YouTube	Channel icon	800 × 800 px	1:1	inside circular crop	
YouTube	Channel banner	2560 × 1440 px	16:9	inset T35% R20% B35% L20%	Text and logo must sit inside the central 1546×423 safe area visible on all devices.
YouTube	Video thumbnail	1280 × 720 px	16:9	inset T5% R18% B15% L5%	Duration badge covers the lower-right.
YouTube	Video watermark	150 × 150 px	1:1	8% margin	
YouTube	Short	1080 × 1920 px	9:16	inset T12% R15% B25% L6%	
Website sharing (Open Graph)	Open Graph / social share image	1200 × 630 px	1.90:1	inset T8% R8% B8% L8%	

Accessibility features by platform

Platform	Image descriptions (alt text)	Video captions
Instagram	Supported: Advanced settings > Accessibility > Write alt text (feed posts).	Auto-captions available for Reels; review and correct them, or burn in reviewed open captions.
LinkedIn	Supported: Alt text option when adding an image to a post.	Upload an .srt caption file with native video.
X (Twitter)	Supported: Add description when attaching an image (up to 1,000 characters).	Upload an .srt caption file with video via Media Studio, or burn in reviewed captions.
YouTube	No image alt text; describe visuals in the video, title and description, and provide accurate captions.	Upload reviewed caption files; do not rely on unedited auto-captions.
Website sharing (Open Graph)	Set og:image:alt and twitter:image:alt meta tags.	n/a

Safe zones

Keep all text, logos and key data inside the dashed safe zone. Platform interfaces cover the edges: Story and Reel captions and buttons at the top and bottom, the duration badge in the lower-right of YouTube thumbnails, and profile photos in the lower-left of LinkedIn and X headers.

Logo on posts

- Put the white symbol in the **top-left corner**, inside the safe zone, on every branded graphic. A single corner means it never clashes with the YouTube duration badge or Story controls.
- Size the symbol at 6–8% of the shorter side of the image (65–86px on a 1,080px canvas), and never below 48px on the canvas.
- Use the full logo only on cover or title slides, at least 240px wide on a 1,080px canvas. Feeds shrink images to about 40%, so anything smaller drops below the logo's 160px minimum and "LABS" becomes unreadable.

Text on images

- Use no more than about 20 words on an image. Repeat every word of it in the caption or alt text.
- Make text at least 4% of the image height (at least 43px on a 1,080px canvas). Use Manrope for headlines and Inter for supporting text.
- Use only these pairings for text on graphics:

Text	Background	Contrast	Use
White	Polar Night	14.59:1	Any text
White	Fjord Teal	5.95:1	Any text
Daybreak Amber	Polar Night	7.11:1	Highlighted numbers and short headlines
Polar Night	Daybreak Amber	7.11:1	Short labels and tags

Warning Never use Fjord Teal text on Polar Night (2.45:1), Daybreak Amber on Fjord Teal (2.9:1) or Daybreak Amber text on white (2.05:1). All three fail.

Data and charts on social

Charts are our most-shared content and the easiest to misread. Follow the data visualisation chapter, and on social also:

- Show one point per graphic. Put the takeaway in the headline ("Heat-related call-outs rose in July"), not just the topic.
- Label lines and bars directly instead of using a colour-only legend, and give chart marks at least 3:1 contrast against the background.
- State the source, the date range and whether figures are measured, modelled or forecast, in the graphic or the first line of the caption.
- Never crop axes to exaggerate a change, and never present a forecast as a fact.

Carousels

- **Slide 1:** a consistent cover using the template, with the takeaway in the headline.
- **Slides 2 onwards:** number every slide in the top-right ("2/7"). Use a maximum of 10 slides.
- **Final slide:** one call to action, such as "Read the full report: northwindlabs.example/..." or "Register for the webinar".
- Add alt text to each image. LinkedIn document (PDF) carousels cannot take alt text per page, so put a text summary of every slide in the post or link to an accessible version.

Video

- **Intro:** 2 seconds or less, or none at all. Put the point in the first 3 seconds.
- **Outro:** no more than 5 seconds, showing the full logo and one call to action.
- **Lower thirds:** name and role in white Inter on a Polar Night box, left-aligned inside the safe zone, on screen for at least 4 seconds.
- **Burned-in captions:** white Inter on a Polar Night box at least 80% opaque, no more than two lines, placed above the platform's bottom interface.

Content pillars

Plan around five themes, and review the mix every quarter. The shares are approximate.

Pillar	Purpose	Share
Climate data insight	Explain what the data shows about heat, flooding, energy and emissions in cities, with sources	35%
Customer and partner stories	Show real outcomes, only with written permission and approved figures	20%
How it works	Open up our methods, data sources, models and their limits, to build trust with technical buyers	20%
Events and learning	Webinars, conferences and guides for sustainability officers and utility engineers	15%
People and culture	The team, hiring and how we work	10%

Accessibility Every pillar includes data and visuals. Write the alt text when you design the graphic, not at the moment of posting.

Writing for social

Our voice on social is the same as everywhere else: confident, precise and optimistic (see chapter 11, Voice and tone). On social, be a little shorter and a little warmer.

- **LinkedIn:** expert and practical. Write up to 1,300 characters, with short paragraphs and a hook in the first 2 lines.
- **X:** direct, with one point per post. Use threads for explainers, and number them ("1/5").
- **YouTube:** say in the title what the viewer will learn. In the description, put a summary first, then chapters, links and the transcript.
- **Instagram:** human and visual. Lead with people and places, and keep captions under 150 words.

Structure each caption as: a **hook** (the first ~125 characters), the **value** in plain language, **one call to action**, then mentions and hashtags.

- **Links:** say where a link goes ("Read the full methodology: [link]"). Use our own domain for short links.
- **Mentions:** tag partners, cities and people only when they appear in the post and have agreed to it. Never tag public officials to push a sale.
- **Claims:** be optimistic, never overclaiming. Substantiate every environmental claim with evidence we can show, in line with the CMA Green Claims Code and section 11 (environmental claims) of the CAP Code. Avoid vague terms such as "green", "eco-friendly" or "carbon neutral" unless the claim is specific, measured and approved.

Do write (illustrative figures): "Our model estimates a 12% drop in peak demand for the pilot district (modelled, 2025 data). Method in the comments." This uses an approved figure with its basis.

Don't write: "We're saving the planet one city at a time." It is vague, unprovable and reads as greenwashing.

Hashtags

- **Brand hashtag:** #NorthwindLabs.
- **Topic hashtags (approved starting set):** #ClimateData, #ClimateAdaptation, #UrbanResilience, #EnergyTransition, #SmartCities.
- **Campaign hashtags:** CamelCase, short and unique. Check that a campaign tag is not already in use before launch, and retire it when the campaign ends.
- Always write hashtags in CamelCase (#ClimateData, not #climatedata) so screen readers read the separate words.
- Place hashtags at the end of the post, never mid-sentence. The one exception is the disclosure label '#ad' or 'Ad', which goes at the start of the post.

Platform	Hashtags per post
LinkedIn	3–5
X	1–2
Instagram	3–5
YouTube	2–3, in the description

Emoji

Emoji are optional. Our voice is precise, so we use them as signposts, not decoration.

- **Approved set:** chart increasing, globe showing Europe-Africa, high voltage, droplet, sun, calendar, pushpin, right arrow, and the national flag for a named event location.
- Use no more than 3 per post, and never more than one in a row.
- Put them at the end of a sentence or as a list marker. Never use them in place of a word: screen readers read out the emoji's full name.
- Never put emoji in display names, alt text or hashtags.

Accessibility on social

This section is mandatory for every post, on every account, including employees posting on our behalf.

- **Alt text on every image.** Describe the purpose, not just the picture. For charts, give the chart type, what it measures, the trend, the key numbers and the source. For example (illustrative figures): "Line chart of daily peak electricity demand in the pilot district, June to August 2025. Demand peaks at 410 megawatts on 18 July, the hottest day. Source: utility meter data." For complex graphics, add a link to a full text or data version.
- **Captions on every video.** Review and correct auto-captions before publishing. Upload a caption file (.srt) where the platform supports it, and burn in reviewed captions for Reels and Shorts. Link webinar transcripts from the description.
- **Design for sound off.** Do not rely on audio alone to carry meaning. Describe key visuals out loud when they carry information.
- **Repeat text from images** in the caption or alt text.
- **Use CamelCase hashtags** and no more than 3 emoji.
- **Never use Unicode "fonts"** (mathematical bold or italic letters). Screen readers skip them or read them letter by letter, and search cannot find them.
- **Check contrast on graphics:** 4.5:1 for text (3:1 for display text of 24px or more), and 3:1 for chart marks. Never use colour alone to carry meaning.

- **No flashing:** nothing that flashes more than three times a second. Add a warning before any unavoidable strobe.
- **Use plain language:** spell out acronyms the first time (for example "megawatts (MW)"), and keep to one idea per sentence.
- **Describe links:** never write "link in bio" or "click here" without saying what the link is.

Accessibility features by platform

Platform	Image alt text	Video captions
LinkedIn	Use the alt text option when you add an image	Upload a .srt caption file with native video
X	Add a description when you attach an image (up to 1,000 characters)	Upload a .srt file through Media Studio, or burn in reviewed captions
YouTube	No image alt text: describe visuals in the video, title and description	Upload reviewed caption files. Never rely on unedited auto-captions
Instagram	Advanced settings > Accessibility > Write alt text (feed posts)	Review auto-captions on Reels, or burn in reviewed captions
Web	Set the <code>og:image:alt</code> and <code>twitter:image:alt</code> meta tags	Not applicable

Community management

Reply as Northwind Labs: knowledgeable, calm and helpful. Never sarcastic, and never defensive. Thank people for corrections. The Marketing team monitors official accounts from 09:00 to 17:30 UK time, Monday to Friday.

Situation	Response time (business hours)	What to do
Question about our work or data	Same business day	Answer, or link to the method or help page. Bring in a specialist for technical questions
Sales or procurement enquiry	Same business day	Thank them and move to email or a direct message. Pass to the sales lead
Complaint	Within 4 business hours	Acknowledge, apologise where appropriate, take it private, then follow up publicly once it is resolved
Error in our data or post	Within 2 business hours	Confirm with the data owner, then correct it publicly (see below)
Misinformation about us	Same day	Correct once, calmly, with a source. Do not argue
Abuse, hate or harassment	Immediately	Hide or remove, report to the platform, and keep a screenshot. Never engage

- **Take it private** whenever a conversation involves personal data, account details, contract terms or an individual customer's situation.

- **Moderation:** remove spam, abuse, personal data, threats and illegal content. Do not remove criticism just because it is critical. Our house rules should be published on the website.
- **Escalation:** social lead, then Head of Marketing, then the relevant executive. Bring in Legal for any legal threat, regulator or press enquiry.
- **Corrections:** never silently delete a post with a wrong figure that has been shared. Edit it or post a correction that says what changed, and pin the correction for 7 days.

Crisis and sensitive moments

A crisis could be a data error that affects a client's decision, a security incident, an extreme weather event in a city we serve, or a story about the company in the news.

1. **Pause** all scheduled posts on every channel within 30 minutes of the crisis being declared.
2. **Alert** the social lead, Head of Marketing, the executive on call and Legal.
3. **Hold:** publish only an approved holding statement, if one is needed. For example: "We're aware of [issue] and are looking into it now. We'll share an update by [time]. Questions: hello@northwindlabs.example."
4. **Approve:** every crisis post needs sign-off from the executive on call and Legal. Nobody else posts or replies on the subject, including employees on personal accounts.
5. **Update** at the times you promised, even if there is no news.
6. **Resume** scheduled content only when the Head of Marketing agrees, and review it for tone first.

Stay silent on events where we have no expertise or role. During disasters and extreme weather, do not post promotional content, and never use a disaster to sell. Before local elections, respect the pre-election period rules that apply to our council clients: do not publish content featuring their officers or initiatives without their communications team's approval.

Employee advocacy

We welcome staff sharing our work. Personal accounts are personal, so these rules protect you and us.

- **Share freely:** published posts, reports, job adverts, webinars and event news.
- **Never share:** client names or data not yet announced, internal figures, unreleased products, security details, or anything under a non-disclosure agreement.
- **Disclose:** say that you work at Northwind Labs when you post about our products or our market. A line in your profile and "(I work here)" on promotional posts is enough.
- **Personal views:** your profile can say that views are your own, but this does not cover confidential information.
- **LinkedIn banner:** staff may use the personal banner (1,584 × 396) from the asset kit. Do not edit it apart from the approved variants.
- **Crisis:** do not comment on a crisis. Share only the official statement.

Partners, influencers and user-generated content

- **Disclosure:** any post we pay for, give something of value for, or control is an advert under the UK ASA/CAP rules. Label it "#ad" or "Ad" at the start of the post, and also use the platform's paid-partnership label. A label at the end of the post or hidden among hashtags is not enough. Legal reviews every paid partnership before it goes live.
- **Co-branded posts:** follow chapter 19, Co-branding and partnerships, for logo lock-ups and approvals. Both parties approve the final post.
- **User-generated content:** ask the creator for permission in writing (a reply or direct message is enough) before reposting, credit them by handle, and do not edit their content beyond cropping to fit. Never repost content that shows identifiable members of the public without consent.

Governance

- **Who can post:** only trained members of the Marketing team, and named delegates they approve, can post on official accounts.
- **Approvals:** routine posts need one reviewer. Posts with data claims need sign-off from the data owner. Client stories need written approval from the client. Paid, partner and crisis posts need Legal.
- **Account security:** use two-factor authentication on every account and store logins in the business password manager. Never use shared personal logins. Remove access on the day someone leaves, and review admins every quarter.
- **Account register:** the Marketing team keeps a register of every official account, its owner, its admins and its recovery details.
- **Records:** *Proposed — confirm with leadership:* keep approvals, published posts and crisis logs for 24 months, in line with chapter 20.
- **Privacy:** never post personal data. Get written consent for photos of identifiable people, and parental consent for anyone under 18. Avoid showing children at all unless it is essential.
- **Spec review:** platform specifications were last reviewed on 2 October 2026. Review them again by 2 April 2027, or sooner if a platform changes its layout.

Social media: do and don't

Do use the generated templates, keep the logo and text inside the safe zone, and put the symbol in the top-left corner.

Do add alt text and reviewed captions to every post, and give the source and basis for every number.

Don't alter the avatar, use Unicode "fonts", stack emoji, or put hashtags in lowercase.

Don't publish an environmental claim, a client figure or a paid partnership without the approvals listed above.

Pre-publish checklist

- [] **Brand:** the correct template, logo top-left inside the safe zone, and approved colour pairings only.
- [] **Accuracy:** each number has a source and a date range, and is labelled as measured, modelled or forecast. The data owner has approved it.
- [] **Accessibility:** alt text, reviewed captions, text from the image repeated, CamelCase hashtags, 3 emoji or fewer, no Unicode "fonts", no flashing, and descriptive links.
- [] **Legal:** permissions and consent are in place, #ad is at the start where needed, and environmental claims are substantiated.
- [] **Proofread:** UK English spelling, names and handles are correct, and links work.

Print and stationery

Printed pieces travel into council chambers, utility control rooms and investor meetings, often without us there to explain them. They must look as precise as our data and be readable by everyone, including people with low vision reading a tender pack under office lighting.

Our default market is the UK, so all specifications use A-series paper and UK sizes. Order print through the Marketing team (hello@northwindlabs.example), who hold the master artwork and approve proofs.

Business cards

Size: 85 × 55 mm (UK standard), landscape, with 3 mm bleed and a 4 mm safe margin inside the trim.

Side	Content
Front	Primary full-colour logo on white, top left, about 40 mm wide, with full clear space (chapter 3)
Front	Name in Manrope bold, job title in Inter regular, then direct phone, email and [Website], left-aligned to the logo's left edge
Back	Solid Fjord Teal or Polar Night with the single-colour light logo or the symbol, centred

- Information hierarchy: name, job title, email, phone, web address. Leave out anything a person will not use.
- Minimum text size is 8pt, including contact details. Reversed (light on dark) text is at least 8pt and never in a light weight.
- Use a matt or uncoated stock of 400 gsm or heavier. Matt stock reduces glare and takes handwriting.
- A QR code is optional. If you use one, print the short web address next to it.

Do keep the front white with the full-colour logo; it is the most recognisable version.

Don't print the full-colour logo on the Fjord Teal or Polar Night side: the teal circle disappears. Use the single-colour light logo.

Letterhead

Size: A4 (210 × 297 mm). Margins of at least 20 mm on all sides.

- Logo: primary full-colour, top left, about 50 mm wide, aligned to the left text margin.
- Footer: a single line or two-column block in Inter at 8pt, in Polar Night: Northwind Labs | [Address line] | [Town] [Postcode] | hello@northwindlabs.example | [Website].
- If Northwind Labs is a UK registered company, the registered name, company number, place of registration and registered office address must appear on business letters. *Proposed — confirm with leadership:* add [Registered company name], registered in [England and Wales], company number [number], registered office [address] in the footer at 8pt minimum.
- Body copy: Inter (or the office substitute in chapter 17) at 11pt, left-aligned, ragged right, never justified.
- Keep a **digital letterhead** as a Word template (.dotx) built with real styles (chapter 17). Most letters are now sent as PDF; export them as tagged PDFs.

- Print the pre-printed version on 100–120 gsm uncoated paper that works with office laser printers.

Envelopes and compliment slips

Item	Size	Logo	Notes
DL envelope	110 × 220 mm	Symbol or primary logo, top left of the flap side or front, at least 30 mm from the address area	Fits A4 folded in three; standard UK business envelope
C5 envelope	162 × 229 mm	Primary logo top left	A4 folded once
C4 envelope	229 × 324 mm	Primary logo top left	A4 flat, for tender packs and reports
Compliment slip	99 × 210 mm (⅓ A4)	Primary logo top left	Contact line in the footer as on the letterhead

- Keep the address window, postage area and the bottom 15 mm clear. Royal Mail sorting machines read these areas; check the current Royal Mail guidance with your printer.
- Return address on the back flap: Northwind Labs, [Address line], [Town] [Postcode].

Brochures, flyers and reports

- Build A4 pages on a 12-column grid with 15–20 mm outer margins and a 5 mm gutter, following the composition principles in chapter 6.
- Bleed is 3 mm on every edge. Keep text and logos at least 5 mm inside the trim.
- Place the logo on the front cover bottom left or top left, and on the back cover with the contact details. Use one placement per document series and keep it consistent across a campaign.
- Covers can use a large Fjord Teal or Polar Night panel. Keep to the colour proportions in chapter 4: mostly white and neutral, with Daybreak Amber used for small highlights only.
- Headlines in Manrope, body in Inter at 10–12pt, charts following chapter 9.
- Images are 300 ppi at final size. Logos and type are always vector (PDF or EPS), never pasted screenshots.

Posters and large format

- Common sizes: A3, A2, A1, A0. Scale the logo to roughly one-sixth to one-quarter of the poster width.
- One message, one headline. The headline should be readable from 3 m on an A2 poster: at least 72pt.
- Keep the bottom 10% clear for the logo, the call to action and the short web address.

Print colour and paper

- Supply artwork in CMYK for process print. The CMYK values in chapter 4 are a starting conversion: ask the printer for a hard proof on the actual stock before every first run.
- Pantone (spot) values must be matched from a physical Pantone swatch book under daylight conditions. Coated (C) and uncoated (U) swatches differ visibly, so specify which one the job uses.

- Fjord Teal and Polar Night lose saturation on uncoated stock. Check the proof against the previous approved print, not against a screen.
- Large Polar Night areas: ask the printer for a rich black-style build based on Polar Night so it does not look grey. Small text stays in a single solid colour to avoid misregistration.
- Paper: matt, silk or uncoated finishes. Avoid high gloss on anything people read, because it reflects light. Choose FSC-certified or recycled stock; it suits a climate business.

Accessible print

- Body text at least 11pt, ideally 12pt, for reports, letters and tender documents.
- Use the approved text pairings in chapter 4 only. Daybreak Amber is never used for text on white or light paper; use `accent-600` if you need amber text.
- Never place text over a busy photograph. Use a solid panel behind it.
- Left-aligned text, no justified paragraphs, no long passages in capitals or italics.
- Every QR code has a printed short web address next to it, so people without a smartphone can still follow it.
- Offer a **large-print version** (at least 16pt body, same content, simplified layout) and an accessible digital version on request. State this on the back cover: "This document is available in large print and accessible formats. Email hello@northwindlabs.example."

Do order a hard proof on the final paper before any run over 250 copies.

Don't approve colour from a screen or a PDF alone; screens are not calibrated to print.

Files and handover to printers

- Send print-ready PDF (PDF/X-4 is a good default) with crop marks, 3 mm bleed and fonts embedded.
- Name files `northwind-labs-[item]-[size]-[version].pdf`, for example `northwind-labs-business-card-85x55-v2.pdf`.
- Download master logo files from the asset library listed in chapter 20.

Presentations and documents

Tender responses, council reports and investor decks are where we win or lose work. Public-sector buyers must publish accessible documents themselves, and they may score suppliers on whether ours are accessible too. A well-built template makes every document on-brand and accessible by default, so you can focus on the content.

All templates are owned by the Marketing team. Request them from hello@northwindlabs.example; do not build your own from an old file.

Fonts in Office and Google tools

Manrope, Inter and JetBrains Mono are free under the SIL Open Font License, so anyone can install them. However, documents we send outside are opened on computers that do not have them, and Word and PowerPoint then substitute fonts unpredictably.

Use	Brand font (installed)	Office substitute for shared files
Headings	Manrope	Arial bold
Body	Inter	Arial
Data, code, IDs	JetBrains Mono	Consolas

- **Templates for external editing** (tender forms, Word documents clients will edit, procurement portal uploads): use the substitutes. Arial is installed on every Windows and Mac computer and in Microsoft 365 on the web.
- **Internal or PDF-only documents:** use the brand fonts. When exporting to PDF, the fonts are embedded, so recipients see them correctly.
- **PowerPoint on Windows:** you may embed the brand fonts (File > Options > Save > Embed fonts in the file). Check the file on a Mac before sending, because embedding support differs.
- **Google Docs and Slides:** Manrope, Inter and JetBrains Mono are available under "More fonts".

Proposed — confirm with leadership: Arial and Consolas are the official substitutes. Aptos (the Microsoft 365 default) is a reasonable alternative inside Microsoft 365, but it is not available in older Office versions or Google tools.

Slide templates

Format: 16:9 (1920 × 1080 px, or 13.33 × 7.5 in in PowerPoint). Keep all text and logos inside a safe area of 64px from every edge so nothing is cropped on projectors.

Layout	Use	Brand treatment
Title	Opening slide	Polar Night background, single-colour light logo top left, title in Manrope
Section	Divider between parts	Fjord Teal background, white title, symbol bottom right
Content	Heading and up to 6 bullet points	White background, small full-colour logo bottom left
Two-column	Comparison, text and image	White, 2 equal columns
Image	One full-bleed photo with a caption	Caption on a solid panel, never directly on the photo
Quote	Client or partner quote	Neutral-50 background, quote in Manrope, attribution in Inter
Data	One chart with a takeaway headline	White, chart colours from chapter 9
End	Contact and call to action	Polar Night, single-colour light logo, hello@northwindlabs.example

- Slide text is at least 24pt; titles 36–44pt. If text will not fit at 24pt, split the slide.
- One idea per slide. Write the takeaway as the slide title (an illustrative example: "Street-level heat data shows where tree planting cools most"), not a topic label ("Results").
- Daybreak Amber is for small highlights: a rule under a title, a key data point marker. Never for text on white; on dark slides, Daybreak Amber text on Polar Night is approved.
- The logo appears once per slide at most, in the same place, and is never animated by slide transitions.

Accessible slides

1. Build every slide from a layout in the master. Never add free text boxes for content; they fall outside the reading order.
2. Give every slide a unique title, even if you hide it visually. Screen-reader users navigate by titles.
3. Check and fix the reading order (PowerPoint: Home > Arrange > Selection Pane, or the Reading Order pane).
4. Add alt text to every meaningful image and chart. Mark decorative images as decorative.
5. Never put text inside images. Charts must have a text summary in the notes or on the slide.
6. Use real lists and table header rows.
7. Run the built-in checker (PowerPoint: Review > Check Accessibility; Keynote and Google Slides: review manually against this list) and fix every error before sending.
8. Avoid auto-advancing slides and flashing transitions. Use fade or no transition.

Document templates

We maintain Word templates (`.dotx`) and Google Docs equivalents for:

Template	Typical use
Report	Council and utility reports, research summaries
Proposal / tender response	Procurement responses, statements of work
Letter	Formal correspondence on the digital letterhead (chapter 16)
Policy	Internal and published policies, accessibility statements

Rules for every document

- Use the built-in styles: Title, Heading 1, Heading 2, Heading 3, Normal, List Bullet, List Number, Caption. Never fake a heading by making text bold and bigger.
- One Heading 1 per document (usually the title), and never skip levels.
- Body text at least 11pt (12pt recommended), line spacing at least 1.5, left-aligned, never justified.
- Tables: simple grids with a header row marked as "Repeat as header row", no merged or empty cells used for layout. Add a caption above each table.
- Links have descriptive text ("Download the 2026 heat-risk methodology"), never a bare URL or "click here".
- Use colour from the approved text pairings in chapter 4 only. Headings in Polar Night or Fjord Teal; never Daybreak Amber text on white.
- Cover pages: logo top left, title in Heading style, then date, version and document owner.
- Run Review > Check Accessibility in Word and fix every error.

Tagged PDFs

Most tender and council documents end up as PDF. Export them as **tagged PDF** so screen readers can follow the structure.

- In Word: File > Save As > PDF > Options, and tick "Document structure tags for accessibility" and "Create bookmarks using headings".
- Set the document title (File > Info > Properties > Title) and language (English UK) before exporting. Set the PDF to display the document title, not the file name.
- Check the PDF with an accessibility checker such as the Adobe Acrobat Accessibility Checker or the free PAC tool, and fix reading order, alt text and table headers.
- Never scan a document to PDF as an image. If you must share a signed form, also provide the accessible version.

Accessibility A public-sector client may need to publish our report on their website. If it is not accessible, they cannot publish it, and that reflects on us.

Do start every document from the current template and its styles.

Don't paste slides or pages as images into another document; the text becomes unreadable to assistive technology and search.

File naming and version control

- Name files `northwind-labs-[client or project]-[document type]-[yyyy-mm-dd]-v[n].[ext]`, for example `northwind-labs-cityname-tender-response-2026-10-02-v3.docx`. Use

lowercase and hyphens, no spaces.

- Mark drafts with "DRAFT" in the header, and remove it before issue.
- Keep one source file in the shared drive. Do not email edited copies back and forth.
- Record the version, date and owner in the document properties and on the cover of reports and proposals.

Signage, environment and merchandise

Physical items are seen at a distance, in poor light and in passing: a booth across a conference hall, a sign on a glass door, a lanyard at a council workshop. They need the simplest, boldest version of the brand, and they must work for people with low vision or who use a wheelchair.

The logo's strong geometry helps here. The circle-and-peak symbol stays recognisable when it is large, small, embroidered or cut from vinyl. Commission all physical items through the Marketing team (hello@northwindlabs.example) and get a proof signed off before production.

Signage

Sizing for viewing distance

As a rule of thumb, allow about 25 mm of cap height for every 10 m of viewing distance. Directional signs read at close range have a cap height of at least 15 mm.

Viewing distance	Minimum cap height	Logo
Up to 2 m (door and room signs)	15–20 mm	Symbol, or no logo
5 m (corridor, reception)	15–25 mm	Primary logo at least 150 mm wide
10 m (building entrance)	25 mm	Primary logo at least 400 mm wide
20 m+ (exterior)	50 mm and up	Primary logo or symbol, sized with the sign maker

Contrast and finish

- Aim for a light reflectance value (LRV) difference of at least 70 points between the text and the sign background, and a clear difference between the sign and the wall it sits on.
- Approved sign colourways: Polar Night text on white or neutral-50, white text on Polar Night, white text on Fjord Teal. Daybreak Amber is for accents only, never for sign text on light backgrounds.
- Use a matt, non-reflective finish. Gloss and glass-faced signs glare under spotlights.
- Paint and vinyl colours (for example RAL or NCS references) must be matched to a physical sample of the brand colours; do not pick them from a screen.

Typography on signs

- Inter (or Manrope bold for short names), sentence case, left-aligned or centred on narrow signs.
- No condensed, light or italic weights, and no all-capitals text.

Mounting, tactile and braille signs

For UK premises and venues, **BS 8300** and **Approved Document M** of the Building Regulations give guidance on sign mounting heights, contrast and tactile signs; the venue or landlord's access consultant confirms what applies. Where tactile or braille signs are required, use raised sans-serif characters and Grade 2 braille, and mount them within the height range the guidance

sets. For any office or event outside the UK, check local rules (for example the ADA Standards in the US).

Do confirm mounting heights and tactile requirements with the building's access consultant before ordering.

Don't put sign text over a photograph or a gradient.

Wayfinding pictograms

Use standard public-information symbols (ISO 7001), such as toilets, accessible toilet, lift, stairs and exits. Do not redraw them in a brand style; people recognise the standard shapes. Fire safety signs follow BS ISO 7010 and are never rebranded.

Office branding

- **Reception wall:** the primary logo in dimensional letters or printed vinyl, full colour on a white or light neutral wall, or single-colour light on a Polar Night wall. Centre it at about eye height (around 1500–1600 mm to the centre).
- **Glass doors and walls:** apply manifestations (visibility markings) so people do not walk into the glass. Use a frosted band or a repeated symbol pattern at two heights, roughly 850–1000 mm and 1400–1600 mm from the floor, as Approved Document K and BS 8300 recommend; confirm with the building owner.
- **Meeting rooms:** room names in Inter on a simple sign. Avoid covering walls in logos; one brand moment per room is enough.

Events and conference booths

Item	Size	Rules
Roll-up banner	850 × 2000 mm	Logo in the top 400 mm; key message at 1000–1700 mm, where people read it; nothing important in the bottom 300 mm, which hides behind tables
Booth back wall	Per venue spec (often 3 × 2.5 m)	Logo top left or centred above head height; one headline; a QR code with the written short web address below it
Step-and-repeat backdrop	2.4 × 2.4 m	Repeating symbol and primary logo, with partner logos per chapter 19
Lanyard	15–20 mm wide	Single-colour light logo repeated on Polar Night or Fjord Teal; breakaway safety clasp
Name badge	A6 or 100 × 75 mm	First name at least 24pt bold, organisation and role below; logo small at top; same layout for staff and guests

- Use the single-colour light logo on Fjord Teal or Polar Night panels, and the full-colour logo only on white panels.
- Large Daybreak Amber panels are allowed for impact on booths; use Polar Night text and the single-colour dark logo on them.
- Print booth graphics on matt fabric or matt vinyl to avoid glare under hall lighting.

- Provide a seating area, step-free access to the booth and printed materials in large print on request.

Vehicles

If we brand vehicles (for example field-survey vans), use the primary logo on white or light-grey bodywork, or the single-colour light logo on dark bodywork. Keep the logo on flat panels away from door seams and handles, and repeat the web address in Inter. Follow DVSA and local regulations for any required markings.

Uniforms and embroidery

- Use the symbol or the primary logo, never smaller than 50 mm wide for the primary logo on clothing. Below that, the thin "LABS" letters fill in when stitched.
- Embroidery: use the single-colour version or the full-colour version with thread colours matched by the supplier to physical brand colour samples. Ask for a stitched sample before ordering.
- Garment colours: white, Polar Night-like navy or Fjord Teal-like teal from the supplier's range, chosen against a physical sample.

Merchandise and promotional items

We are a climate business, so every item must be useful, durable and responsibly sourced.

- **Choose:** reusable bottles and cups, recycled or organic cotton bags, notebooks on recycled paper, FSC-certified items.
- **Avoid:** single-use plastics, novelty items people throw away, and anything that contradicts our climate work.
- Print the logo in one colour where possible: single-colour light on dark items, single-colour dark on light items. It reduces cost and print errors.
- Keep the logo above the print minimum in chapter 3 and give it full clear space. On very small items (pens, USB sticks), use the symbol.
- Ask suppliers for a pre-production sample and check colour, placement and quality before approving the run.

Do choose fewer, better items that people will keep.

Don't recolour the logo to match a product's colour; choose a product colour that suits an approved logo version.

Packaging

If we ship physical products (for example sensor kits), packaging follows the print rules in chapter 16 and must carry any legally required text (such as safety, recycling and WEEE markings) at a legible size, at least 8pt, or the size the relevant regulation sets where that is the legal requirement and space genuinely does not allow 8pt.

Co-branding and partnerships

Much of our work is done with city councils, utilities, universities and other climate-tech organisations. When our logo appears next to theirs, the layout tells people who is responsible for what. Getting it right builds trust with public bodies; getting it wrong can breach their rules on endorsement and procurement.

The single most important rule: **each partner's own brand guidelines govern their logo**. Ask for their guidelines and logo files at the start of every partnership, and follow them exactly.

Relationship types

Relationship	Example	Logo hierarchy	Wording
Partnership of equals	A joint research project with a university	Equal optical size, side by side	"In partnership with"
Client-led (we are the supplier)	A heat-risk dashboard for a city council	Client logo leads; ours smaller, or credit in text only	"Powered by Northwind Labs" or "Data by Northwind Labs", only if the client agrees
We lead, partner supports	Our report with a partner's data	Our logo leads; partner logo smaller	"With support from" or "Data from"
Sponsorship	We sponsor an event	Event brand leads; our logo in the sponsor area at the agreed size	"Sponsored by"
Endorsed sub-brand	A Northwind Labs product with its own name	Product name leads; "by Northwind Labs" below or beside it	"by Northwind Labs"

Lock-up rules

1. **Align** logos on a shared horizontal centre line, or a shared baseline if both are wordmarks.
2. **Separate** logos with a thin vertical divider line in neutral-300 (or white at reduced opacity on dark backgrounds) or with a short phrase such as "in partnership with". Never let the logos touch.
3. **Space**: the gap between each logo and the divider is at least our clear space (chapter 3). Our clear space then also surrounds the whole lock-up.
4. **Equal partners** have equal *optical* size, not equal width. Our logo is wide (about five times as wide as it is tall), so match the visual weight by eye; compact or square partner logos usually need to be taller than ours.
5. **Order**: the lead organisation goes first (left, or top in a stacked lock-up). For equal partners, put the host or contracting party first, or use alphabetical order.
6. **Colour**: both logos in full colour, or both in single colour. Do not mix one full-colour logo with one single-colour logo.
7. **Background**: a white or light neutral background usually suits both full-colour logos. On Polar Night or Fjord Teal, use our single-colour light logo and the partner's approved reversed version.
8. **Never** merge our symbol with a partner's mark, recolour a partner logo in our colours, or make a new combined logo without approval from both organisations.

Do ask for each partner's logo files and guidelines in vector format, and check you have the latest version.

Don't download a partner's logo from a search engine or their website header.

Working with government and public-sector logos

Councils, combined authorities, government departments and regulated utilities have strict rules on their identities.

- **Follow their guidelines exactly.** Many councils have their own brand guidelines; UK central government departments use their own identity rules and often do not allow their logo on supplier materials at all.
- **Endorsement:** a public body's logo next to ours can imply that they endorse our company or products. Most public bodies do not permit this outside an agreed joint project. Do not use a client logo in marketing, case studies, client-logo walls or tender responses without written permission from the client's communications team.
- **Coats of arms and crests** are often legally protected. Never use them unless the client supplies the artwork and approves the use.
- **Funded projects:** grants and innovation programmes (for example UK Research and Innovation or local growth funds) often require their logo and a funding statement in a set format. Follow the funder's publicity guidance.
- **Their documents, their template:** if a council publishes a report we contributed to, it uses their template. We appear as a credit line, for example "Analysis by Northwind Labs", unless agreed otherwise.

Sponsorship

- Ask the organiser for the sponsor logo specification (size, colour version, file format) and supply files from the asset library (chapter 20).
- Supply our primary logo as vector (SVG for digital, PDF or EPS for print), plus the single-colour light version for dark backgrounds.
- Ask to see a proof of every item showing our logo before it is printed or published.

Sub-brands and product names

Proposed — confirm with leadership: our brand architecture is **branded house**. Products are named descriptively and endorsed by the master brand, rather than given separate logos.

- Name products plainly: "Northwind [Product name]", for example "Northwind [Heat Risk]" (illustrative placeholder).
- Product names are set in Manrope next to or below the primary logo, separated by our clear space. Do not create a new symbol for a product.
- A product needs its own logo only if the Marketing team and leadership agree it will be sold or partnered separately.

Approvals and lead times

What	Who approves	Lead time
New co-branded lock-up	Marketing team and the partner's brand or communications team	10 working days
Use of a client or public-sector logo	Client's communications team, in writing	10–15 working days; public bodies can take longer
Sponsorship artwork	Marketing team, then the organiser	5 working days after receiving the specification
Partner using our logo	Marketing team	5 working days

Send requests to hello@northwindlabs.example with the item, the format, where it will appear and the deadline. Keep written approvals with the project files.

Proposed — confirm with leadership: the lead times above are starting points for planning.

Partners using our logo

- Partners must use our logo files from the asset library and follow chapter 3 (clear space, minimum size, backgrounds and misuse).
- Partners describe the relationship accurately. They must not imply that we endorse their products unless agreed.

Co-branding accessibility

- Both logos must reach at least 3:1 contrast against the background. If a partner's logo fails on the chosen background, change the background or use their reversed version; never change their colours.
- Alt text names both organisations and the relationship, for example "Northwind Labs in partnership with [Partner name]".
- The relationship is also stated in text (a credit line, caption or page content), not only shown through logos.
- Lock-ups on slides, web pages and social posts follow the same size, contrast and alt-text rules as our own logo.

Legal, governance and assets

A brand only stays consistent if someone owns it, the right files are easy to find, and legal lines are used correctly. This chapter covers trademarks, copyright, licences, approvals, the asset library and how the guide is kept up to date.

Trademarks

Proposed — confirm with legal counsel: we have no record of registered trademarks for the Northwind Labs name or logo. Until legal counsel confirms registration status in each market:

- Do not use the ® symbol. It may only be used for marks registered in the relevant jurisdiction, and misuse can be an offence in the UK.
- Use ™ only if counsel advises it, and then only on the first or most prominent use of the logo or name in a piece, not on every instance.
- Never add a symbol inside the logo artwork. Place any mark outside the clear space, set in the body typeface at a small size.

When writing about the company, always use the full name "Northwind Labs" on first mention, with a capital N and L. Never abbreviate it to "NWL", hyphenate it or write it as one word.

Do write "Northwind Labs" in plain text in body copy, so screen readers and search engines read it correctly.

Don't use the logo in place of the name in a sentence.

Copyright lines

Use this line on reports, websites, presentations and templates: "© [Year] Northwind Labs. All rights reserved." *Proposed — confirm the registered legal entity name with legal counsel and replace "Northwind Labs" with it if it differs.* For open data or reports we want shared widely, legal counsel may approve a Creative Commons licence instead. Name the licence and link to it in full.

Font, image and data licences

Asset	Source	Licence	What it allows
Manrope (display)	Google Fonts	SIL Open Font License 1.1	Free use in print, web, apps, video and social; may be embedded
Inter (body)	Google Fonts	SIL Open Font License 1.1	As above
JetBrains Mono (data and code)	Google Fonts	SIL Open Font License 1.1	As above
Stock photography and illustration	Per supplier	Per image	Check each licence covers the channel, territory and duration
Third-party data and maps	Per provider	Per dataset	Credit the source as the provider requires, on the chart or map itself

Keep licence records for every stock image, music track and dataset in the asset library alongside the file. Never use an image found on a search engine or social media without written permission.

Approvals

What you are making	Who approves	Typical turnaround
Social posts using templates	Social lead in the Marketing team	1 working day
New campaign, website page or report design	Marketing team brand owner	3 working days
Co-branded material with a council, utility or partner	Marketing team brand owner, plus the partner's own brand team	5 working days
Public environmental or performance claims	Marketing team brand owner, plus legal review	5 working days
Any change to the logo, colours or typefaces	Leadership sign-off via the Marketing team	Not routine

Proposed — confirm with leadership: turnaround times above are a starting point.

Do submit work with its alt text, captions and contrast checks, so the review can cover accessibility too.

Don't publish data-led claims about emissions or savings without a named, checkable source.

Owner and contact

The Marketing team owns this guide and the asset library. Send questions, approval requests, requests for new assets and reports of misuse to hello@northwindlabs.example.

Asset library and file naming

All official files live in the asset kit that ships with this guide: logo variants, favicons, social templates and design tokens. Download them from the list below rather than copying from this page.

File names follow the pattern `element-variant-colour[-modifier].format`, all lowercase with hyphens, for example `primary-full-colour.svg`, `symbol-mono-light-knockout.png` or `linkedin-cover-1512x256.png`. Use SVG for digital, PNG where SVG is not supported, and request print-ready PDF or EPS artwork from the Marketing team for professional print.

Logo files

- [primary-full-colour.svg](#) — primary logo, full colour (vector master)
- [primary-mono-dark.svg](#) — primary logo, single colour, solid (for light backgrounds)
- [primary-mono-dark-knockout.svg](#) — primary logo, single colour with inner shapes knocked out (for light backgrounds)
- [primary-mono-light.svg](#) — primary logo, single colour, solid (reversed, for dark backgrounds)
- [primary-mono-light-knockout.svg](#) — primary logo, single colour with inner shapes knocked out (reversed, for dark backgrounds)
- [symbol-full-colour.svg](#) — symbol logo, full colour (vector master)
- [symbol-mono-dark.svg](#) — symbol logo, single colour, solid (for light backgrounds)
- [symbol-mono-dark-knockout.svg](#) — symbol logo, single colour with inner shapes knocked out (for light backgrounds)
- [symbol-mono-light.svg](#) — symbol logo, single colour, solid (reversed, for dark backgrounds)
- [symbol-mono-light-knockout.svg](#) — symbol logo, single colour with inner shapes knocked out (reversed, for dark backgrounds)
- [primary-full-colour.png](#) — primary logo, full colour (PNG, transparent)
- [primary-full-colour-clearspace.png](#) — primary logo, full colour, with minimum clear space built in
- [primary-mono-dark.png](#) — primary logo, mono dark (PNG, transparent)
- [primary-mono-dark-clearspace.png](#) — primary logo, mono dark, with minimum clear space built in
- [primary-mono-light.png](#) — primary logo, mono light (PNG, transparent)
- [primary-mono-light-clearspace.png](#) — primary logo, mono light, with minimum clear space built in
- [primary-mono-dark-knockout.png](#) — primary logo, mono dark knockout (PNG, transparent)
- [primary-mono-dark-knockout-clearspace.png](#) — primary logo, mono dark knockout, with minimum clear space built in
- [primary-mono-light-knockout.png](#) — primary logo, mono light knockout (PNG, transparent)
- [primary-mono-light-knockout-clearspace.png](#) — primary logo, mono light knockout, with minimum clear space built in
- [symbol-full-colour.png](#) — symbol logo, full colour (PNG, transparent)
- [symbol-full-colour-clearspace.png](#) — symbol logo, full colour, with minimum clear space built in
- [symbol-mono-dark.png](#) — symbol logo, mono dark (PNG, transparent)
- [symbol-mono-dark-clearspace.png](#) — symbol logo, mono dark, with minimum clear space built in
- [symbol-mono-light.png](#) — symbol logo, mono light (PNG, transparent)
- [symbol-mono-light-clearspace.png](#) — symbol logo, mono light, with minimum clear space built in

- [symbol-mono-dark-knockout.png](#) — symbol logo, mono dark knockout (PNG, transparent)
- [symbol-mono-dark-knockout-clearspace.png](#) — symbol logo, mono dark knockout, with minimum clear space built in
- [symbol-mono-light-knockout.png](#) — symbol logo, mono light knockout (PNG, transparent)
- [symbol-mono-light-knockout-clearspace.png](#) — symbol logo, mono light knockout, with minimum clear space built in
- ...and 6 more in `assets/Logo/`

Favicons and app icons

- [favicon.ico](#) — Browser favicon (16, 32, 48 px) on a solid brand tile
- [icon-16.png](#) — App/browser icon 16×16
- [icon-32.png](#) — App/browser icon 32×32
- [icon-48.png](#) — App/browser icon 48×48
- [icon-192.png](#) — App/browser icon 192×192
- [icon-512.png](#) — App/browser icon 512×512
- [apple-touch-icon.png](#) — Apple touch icon 180×180 (opaque)
- [icon-maskable-512.png](#) — Android maskable icon 512×512 (content inside safe circle)
- [site.webmanifest](#) — Web app manifest
- [head-snippet.html](#) — HTML <head> tags for favicons

Social media kit

- [linkedin-avatar-400×400.svg](#) — Editable template: LinkedIn Company page logo
- [linkedin-avatar-400×400.png](#) — LinkedIn Company page logo (400×400)
- [linkedin-cover-1512×256.svg](#) — Editable template: LinkedIn Company page cover
- [linkedin-cover-1512×256.png](#) — LinkedIn Company page cover (1512×256)
- [linkedin-personal-banner-1584×396.svg](#) — Editable template: LinkedIn Employee profile banner
- [linkedin-personal-banner-1584×396.png](#) — LinkedIn Employee profile banner (1584×396)
- [linkedin-post-landscape-1200×627.svg](#) — Editable template: LinkedIn Post image (landscape)
- [linkedin-post-landscape-1200×627.png](#) — LinkedIn Post image (landscape) (1200×627) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- [linkedin-post-square-1080×1080.svg](#) — Editable template: LinkedIn Post image (square)
- [linkedin-post-square-1080×1080.png](#) — LinkedIn Post image (square) (1080×1080) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- [linkedin-post-portrait-1080×1350.svg](#) — Editable template: LinkedIn Post image (portrait 4:5)
- [linkedin-post-portrait-1080×1350.png](#) — LinkedIn Post image (portrait 4:5) (1080×1350) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- [x-avatar-400×400.svg](#) — Editable template: X (Twitter) Profile picture
- [x-avatar-400×400.png](#) — X (Twitter) Profile picture (400×400)
- [x-header-1500×500.svg](#) — Editable template: X (Twitter) Header
- [x-header-1500×500.png](#) — X (Twitter) Header (1500×500)
- [x-post-landscape-1600×900.svg](#) — Editable template: X (Twitter) Post image (16:9)
- [x-post-landscape-1600×900.png](#) — X (Twitter) Post image (16:9) (1600×900) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- [x-post-square-1080×1080.svg](#) — Editable template: X (Twitter) Post image (square)
- [x-post-square-1080×1080.png](#) — X (Twitter) Post image (square) (1080×1080) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- [x-card-1200×628.svg](#) — Editable template: X (Twitter) Link card image
- [x-card-1200×628.png](#) — X (Twitter) Link card image (1200×628) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- [youtube-avatar-800×800.svg](#) — Editable template: YouTube Channel icon
- [youtube-avatar-800×800.png](#) — YouTube Channel icon (800×800)
- [youtube-banner-2560×1440.svg](#) — Editable template: YouTube Channel banner
- [youtube-banner-2560×1440.png](#) — YouTube Channel banner (2560×1440)

- [youtube-thumbnail-1280×720.svg](#) — Editable template: YouTube Video thumbnail
- [youtube-thumbnail-1280×720.png](#) — YouTube Video thumbnail (1280×720) layout preview; add the headline using the SVG template
- [youtube-watermark-150×150.svg](#) — Editable template: YouTube Video watermark
- [youtube-watermark-150×150.png](#) — YouTube Video watermark (150×150)
- ...and 16 more in `assets/social/`

Design tokens

- [_tokens.scss](#)
- [tailwind-theme.css](#)
- [tailwind.preset.js](#)
- [tokens.css](#)
- [tokens.json](#)

Review cadence and version history

We review this guide every 12 months, and after any rebrand, major product launch or change to a social platform's specifications. Version numbers follow a simple rule: a patch (1.0.1) for corrections, a minor version (1.1.0) for additions, and a major version (2.0.0) for a rebrand.

Version	Date	Change	Approved by
1.0.0	2 October 2026	First edition, created from the logo with proposed foundations, colour names and typefaces for confirmation	Marketing team (pending confirmation)